

ENGLISH FOR PLUMBING PROJECTS AND CUSTOMER COMMUNICATION

Plumbing Workplace English

Precise descriptions. Clear agreements.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For plumbers, plumbing service coordinators, and project staff working with customers, suppliers, and other trades.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight practical conversations move from a first service call to a final handover: identify fixtures, compare component descriptions, reconcile drawing references, report moisture, explain access, coordinate interruptions, price changes, and close document gaps.

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Name the fixture. Preserve the detail.

Plumbing conversations connect everyday descriptions with technical records. Practice narrowing a report, comparing like quantities, explaining a limitation, and giving a clear next step.

Ask which fixture

Sink can mean a bathroom basin, kitchen sink, or utility sink. Repeat the room, unit, and fixture description before summarizing a customer report. Keep the observation separate from a diagnosis.

"You mean the bathroom basin in Unit 3B, not the utility sink beside it."

Compare matching references

A nominal pipe designation is not necessarily its measured outside diameter. Drawing dimensions also need a datum and endpoint. Confirm the product series and reference before treating different numbers as an error.

"The number alone does not establish whether the delivered component matches the order."

Separate access from drainage

An access panel and a cleanout serve different purposes. Explain the terms in plain language, then keep an unreviewed enclosure change open for coordination rather than approving it conversationally.

"The removable panel provides access; it is not an extra drain."

Commit only to what is agreed

Arrival time, interruption time, estimate scope, and follow-up date are different commitments. State which is booked, proposed, included, or still awaiting review.

"The visit is booked for 09:00; the proposed interruption still needs approval."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

The cases, products, and project records are fictional. This book teaches English, not plumbing diagnosis, installation, testing, repair, valve operation, or code compliance. Follow actual training, authorization, manufacturer instructions, site procedures, and applicable requirements. A reported symptom, dry surface, drawing, or handover document does not establish system condition or authorize work. The conversations do not instruct clients to test, dismantle, or operate plumbing equipment.

Which sink in Unit 3B?

A Read the situation

Clarify a customer report using fixture, location, and observation time without turning a symptom into a diagnosis.

Tenant Mina reports a sink problem in Unit 3B. A bathroom basin and a utility sink stand beside one another. She means the bathroom basin and noticed water on the cabinet base at 07:00. The source of the water has not been established. Service coordinator Ellis needs an accurate description for the plumber, using what Mina has already observed. No earlier repair history is supplied, and no instruction to operate or dismantle equipment is needed.

PEOPLE / Mina: Tenant | Ellis: Service coordinator

CLARIFY WITHOUT MAKING THE CUSTOMER DEFEND A DIAGNOSIS

Customers may use one everyday name for several fixtures. Offer concrete alternatives, acknowledge the reported condition, and ask about existing observations. A precise service description helps the next person without requiring the customer to identify a failed component.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which fixture does Mina mean?

- A The bathroom basin in Unit 3B
- C A kitchen sink elsewhere

- B The utility sink beside it
- D Both fixtures equally

2. What does 07:00 identify?

- A The time a repair finished
- C The proven start of a leak

- B When Mina noticed water
- D A booked arrival time

3. What is known about the source?

- A The basin trap has failed
- C The utility sink is responsible

- B A supply connection has failed
- D It has not been established

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fixture

Plumbing appliance such as a basin, sink, or toilet.

IN USE identify the fixture

bathroom basin

Bowl used for washing hands or face in a bathroom.

IN USE specify the bathroom basin

utility sink

Sink intended for cleaning or general utility tasks.

IN USE distinguish the utility sink

vanity unit

Bathroom cabinet assembly associated with a basin.

IN USE describe the vanity unit

cabinet base

Bottom surface within the cabinet.

IN USE report water on the cabinet base

service call

Request or attendance for a reported plumbing issue.

IN USE log a service call

tenant report

Account given by the person occupying the premises.

IN USE record the tenant report

unit number

Identifier of an individual apartment or premises.

IN USE confirm the unit number

fixture location

Position of the particular plumbing appliance.

IN USE state the fixture location

observation time

Time when someone noticed a condition.

IN USE record the observation time

onset

Point when a condition actually began.

IN USE distinguish onset from observation

source

Origin of the reported water or problem.

IN USE establish the source

Precision check

Water was noticed on the cabinet base at 07:00. This does not establish when it first appeared or which component caused it. Keep the fixture identity, observed location, and time together.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

supply connection

Connection associated with water delivery to a fixture.

IN USE identify a supply connection

waste connection

Connection associated with carrying used water away.

IN USE describe the waste connection

trap

Fitting designed to retain a liquid seal in a drainage system.

IN USE identify the basin trap

faucet

Fitting that controls delivery of water at a fixture.

IN USE name the faucet

tap

Common alternative term for a faucet.

IN USE clarify the tap description

visible moisture

Wetness that can be seen at the reported location.

IN USE describe visible moisture

service history

Record of earlier attendance or work.

IN USE check the service history

previous repair

Corrective work completed on an earlier occasion.

IN USE confirm a previous repair

reported symptom

Condition described by a customer before assessment.

IN USE retain the reported symptom

call summary

Concise record of information from the conversation.

IN USE read back the call summary

unknown cause

Origin or explanation that is not established.

IN USE record an unknown cause

attendance

Visit by the relevant service person.

IN USE arrange attendance

Precision check

The bathroom basin and utility sink are different fixtures. Familiar terms such as tap and faucet can be clarified without correcting the customer unnecessarily. No previous repair or component failure is established here.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OFFER TWO CONCRETE CHOICES

"Do you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink?"

SEPARATE ADJACENT FIXTURES

"The utility sink is beside it, but it is not the fixture you mean."

PRESERVE THE TIME

"You first noticed it at 07:00."

NAME THE SURFACE

"The water was on the cabinet base."

CONFIRM THE PREMISES

"I have the location as Unit 3B."

LOCATE THE OBSERVATION

"Where had you already noticed the water?"

AVOID CHANGING THE ONSET

"I will record that as the observation time."

KEEP THE REPORT ATTRIBUTED

"The tenant reports water beneath the bathroom basin."

Do you mean X or Y?

Offers bounded alternatives that resolve an ambiguous noun.

Noticed at

Records an observation without asserting when the problem began.

Reports

Attributes an account to its source.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE CAUSE OPEN

"The source has not been established."

DISTINGUISH THE ROUTES

"A supply connection and a waste connection are different."

RECORD THE HISTORY LIMIT

"No earlier repair history has been supplied."

READ BACK THE DETAILS

"Bathroom basin, Unit 3B, cabinet base, noticed at 07:00."

AVOID NAMING A FAILED PART

"I cannot identify a failed connection from that description."

CLARIFY FAMILIAR WORDING

"By tap, do you mean the basin faucet?"

AVOID INVENTING REASSURANCE

"I cannot say the issue has been resolved."

CLOSE WITH THE RECORD

"I will pass that description to the plumber."

Beneath versus from

Beneath gives location; from asserts origin.

Has not been established

Leaves a cause open without denying the observation.

No history supplied

Does not mean that no earlier work ever occurred.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question best clarifies the fixture?

- A** Which connection has failed?
- B** Why did the trap start leaking?
- C** Can you dismantle the cabinet connection?
- D** Do you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink beside it?

2. Which summary preserves the time accurately?

- A** Leak began exactly at 07:00
- B** Repair completed at 07:00
- C** Plumber booked for 07:00
- D** Water noticed on the cabinet base at 07:00

3. Which statement wrongly converts location into cause?

- A** Water was seen on the cabinet base
- B** The bathroom basin is the reported fixture
- C** The source needs assessment
- D** The water must be coming from the trap

4. What should accompany the handoff?

- A** A guaranteed diagnosis
- B** Fixture, unit, observed surface, time, and unresolved source
- C** Only the word sink
- D** An invented previous repair

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

Which sink in Unit 3B?

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

bathroom basin / service history / source / cabinet base / attendance / faucet / reported symptom / fixture / observation time / call summary

- 01 **Mina:** I need someone to look at the sink in Unit 3B. I found water underneath it this morning, and I am not sure what to call the problem.
- 02 **Ellis:** Let me identify the ¹ _____ first. Do you mean the bathroom basin, or the utility sink that stands beside it?
- 03 **Mina:** The bathroom one, where we wash our hands. The utility sink is beside the cabinet, but that is not the sink I am talking about.
- 04 **Ellis:** Thank you. I will put ² _____ in the request and keep Unit 3B attached to it. Where had you already noticed the water?
- 05 **Mina:** On the bottom of the cabinet, below that basin. I noticed it at seven this morning. I do not know when it first appeared.
- 06 **Ellis:** I will record water on the ³ _____, noticed at 07:00. That describes the location you saw, not yet where the water came from.
- 07 **Mina:** Exactly. I had started to say the pipe was leaking, but I cannot actually tell you which part it came from.
- 08 **Ellis:** Then the ⁴ _____ remains unknown. We can give the plumber a useful description without naming a failed part before it has been assessed.
- 09 **Mina:** Does saying I saw it at seven make it sound as though the problem began then? I cannot confirm that.
- 10 **Ellis:** No. I will label seven as the ⁵ _____, rather than the start of the problem. That distinction should stay in the call notes.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Mina:** Good. I also do not have a record of any earlier work on that basin, so I cannot give you a repair date.
- 12 **Ellis:** I will mark the ⁶ _____ as not supplied. That does not mean we know there has never been a repair.
- 13 **Mina:** One other thing: I sometimes call the fitting above the basin a tap. Will the plumber understand that, or should I use another word?
- 14 **Ellis:** Tap is understood in many workplaces; ⁷ _____ is another common term. We can clarify the name without suggesting that fitting caused the water.
- 15 **Mina:** That helps. I do not want the request to say the tap has failed simply because I mentioned it in this conversation.
- 16 **Ellis:** It will not. The record will preserve your ⁸ _____ and the fixture location. It will not identify a failed supply or waste connection.
- 17 **Mina:** Please read the short version back to me before you send it. I want the plumber to come to the correct fixture.
- 18 **Ellis:** Here is the ⁹ _____: Unit 3B, bathroom basin, water on the cabinet base, noticed at 07:00. Source unestablished; earlier repair history not supplied.
- 19 **Mina:** Yes, that is accurate. It names the right basin and does not make me sound certain about something I have not identified.
- 20 **Ellis:** I will pass that through for ¹⁰ _____. You have clarified the report; the next assessment must establish the cause rather than assume one from the wording.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. fixture | 2. bathroom basin | 3. cabinet base | 4. source | 5. observation time | 6. service history | 7. faucet | 8. reported symptom | 9. call summary | 10. attendance

Give the plumber the precise report

F Say it

Complete the handoff using the tenant account. Keep the fixture, observed surface, time, and cause status distinct.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

basin / unestablished / 07:00 / base

Coordinator: "The tenant means the bathroom ¹ _____ in Unit 3B."

Plumber: "Water was seen on the cabinet ² _____."

Coordinator: "It was noticed at ³ _____."

Plumber: "The source remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. basin | 2. base | 3. 07:00 | 4. unestablished

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A designation is not a measurement

A Read the situation

Distinguish nominal size from measured outside diameter and request complete product identification before judging a delivery.

Buyer Omar compares a nominal pipe designation on an order with a measured outside diameter and assumes the delivery is wrong because the numbers differ. The order names a product series, but the delivery label is incomplete. Supplier coordinator Leila must explain the two kinds of size information and request complete identification. Neither material compatibility nor connection compatibility has been verified. Explaining nominal size does not establish that the delivery is correct.

PEOPLE / Omar: Buyer | Leila: Supplier coordinator

CORRECT THE COMPARISON WITHOUT DISMISSING THE CONCERN

A customer can make an invalid comparison and still have a genuine delivery problem. Explain the terminology, then investigate the actual item identity. Avoid moving from the numbers are different to either the goods are wrong or the goods are definitely right.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is Omar comparing?

- A** Identical manufacturer part numbers
- B** A nominal designation and a measured outside diameter
- C** Two verified inside diameters
- D** Two complete product labels

2. What information is incomplete?

- A** The delivery label
- B** The fact that an order exists
- C** The buyer's concern
- D** The meaning of outside

3. What remains unverified?

- A** That the measured number differs
- B** That the order lists a series
- C** That Omar has a question
- D** Product identity and relevant compatibility

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

nominal size

Conventional size designation that may differ from a measured diameter.

IN USE confirm the nominal size

outside diameter

Measurement across the outer surface of a pipe.

IN USE compare the outside diameter

inside diameter

Measurement across the internal opening of a pipe.

IN USE distinguish inside diameter

wall thickness

Distance between the inner and outer pipe surfaces.

IN USE specify the wall thickness

size designation

Standard or commercial name used to identify a size.

IN USE read the size designation

measured dimension

Numerical value obtained from an actual measurement.

IN USE record the measured dimension

product series

Named family of related products.

IN USE identify the product series

part number

Manufacturer identifier for a particular item.

IN USE verify the part number

delivery label

Identification attached to supplied goods.

IN USE check the delivery label

order line

Individual item entry in a purchase order.

IN USE reconcile the order line

material specification

Description of required material characteristics.

IN USE confirm the material specification

connection type

Form of interface used to join components.

IN USE identify the connection type

Precision check

A nominal designation and an outside diameter are different kinds of information. Different numerical values alone do not establish an incorrect delivery. The relevant product series and manufacturer data must be identified.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

fitting

Component used to connect, branch, or change a pipe run.

IN USE identify the fitting

coupling

Fitting used to join pipe sections or components.

IN USE specify the coupling

adapter

Fitting joining different connection forms or sizes as designed.

IN USE identify the adapter

elbow

Fitting that changes the direction of a pipe run.

IN USE identify the elbow

tee

Fitting with a branch connection.

IN USE specify the tee

reducer

Fitting connecting different nominal pipe sizes.

IN USE identify the reducer

product identification

Information establishing which item has been supplied.

IN USE complete product identification

compatibility

Suitability of components for use together under relevant conditions.

IN USE verify compatibility

substitution

Replacement of a specified product with another.

IN USE review a substitution

dimensional table

Manufacturer data listing defined dimensions.

IN USE consult the dimensional table

supply discrepancy

Difference between ordered and supplied goods or records.

IN USE investigate a supply discrepancy

acceptance status

Whether goods have been accepted through the applicable process.

IN USE preserve acceptance status

Precision check

Correcting the size comparison does not verify the delivered item. The label is incomplete, and material and connection compatibility remain unverified. Do not replace one unsupported conclusion with automatic acceptance.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I understand why those two numbers look inconsistent."

EXPLAIN NOMINAL

"Nominal size is a designation, not necessarily that measured diameter."

ASK FOR IDENTITY

"We need the complete product identification."

IDENTIFY THE MISSING RECORD

"The delivery label is incomplete."

NAME THE COMPARISON

"One is a nominal designation; the other is a measured outside diameter."

RETAIN THE MEASUREMENT

"We should keep your measurement in the record."

USE THE ORDER REFERENCE

"The order names a particular product series."

AVOID PREMATURE REJECTION

"The numerical difference alone does not prove the delivery is wrong."

Not necessarily

Rejects a universal assumption without asserting that the values always differ.

One ... the other

Contrasts two clearly identified quantities.

Alone

Limits what a single piece of evidence can establish.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID PREMATURE ACCEPTANCE

"That explanation does not confirm the delivery is correct."

REQUEST THE RIGHT DOCUMENT

"Please obtain the full label details through the supplier."

DISTINGUISH FITTING TYPES

"An adapter and a coupling are not interchangeable descriptions."

STATE THE NEXT STEP

"I will reconcile the item identity with the order."

SEPARATE COMPATIBILITY

"We still need to verify the material and connection requirements."

NAME THE DATA SOURCE

"The matching manufacturer table defines the relevant dimensions."

KEEP SUBSTITUTION SEPARATE

"We have not approved an alternative product."

GIVE A BALANCED SUMMARY

"The size comparison is clarified; the delivery remains unverified."

Still need to

Keeps a remaining verification step explicit.

Matches the designation

Does not by itself establish material or connection compatibility.

Unverified

Neither accepts nor rejects the product without evidence.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response best corrects the comparison?

- A** The explanation proves all supplied goods are suitable
- B** Nominal size and outside diameter are different; we still need full item identification
- C** Different numbers always prove the wrong item
- D** Nominal always equals measured outside diameter

2. Which information should Leila request next?

- A** Immediate installation approval
- B** Only the color of the packaging
- C** Complete label details and product identification
- D** An invented replacement size

3. Which conclusion is unsupported?

- A** The order names a product series
- B** The label is incomplete
- C** The numerical comparison needs clarification
- D** The material and connection are compatible

4. What does a dimensional table need to match?

- A** The relevant identified product and series
- B** Any pipe with a similar color
- C** A different manufacturer's unrelated item
- D** The buyer's preferred number

Answers and explanations: page 78.

A designation is not a measurement

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

product identification / product series / acceptance status / dimensional table / part number / supply discrepancy / connection type / substitution / outside diameter / nominal size

- 01 **Omar:** I think the pipe delivery is the wrong size. The number on our order does not match the outside measurement I have recorded.
- 02 **Leila:** Are you comparing the order's ¹ _____ with an outside measurement? Those can be different kinds of information even when the item is correctly identified.
- 03 **Omar:** Yes, that is the comparison. I assumed the ordered size had to equal the measurement across the outside, so I flagged the delivery.
- 04 **Leila:** The ² _____ is a physical dimension. The nominal designation names the size within the relevant system; we should not assume the two numbers must match.
- 05 **Omar:** So should I remove the delivery query and tell the site team the goods are correct? I do not want to hold them unnecessarily.
- 06 **Leila:** Not yet. We have clarified the comparison, not the ³ _____. The label is incomplete, so I cannot confirm which exact item arrived.
- 07 **Omar:** The order does name the series we wanted. I can give you that order reference, but the delivery label does not show everything.
- 08 **Leila:** Good. We can use the ⁴ _____ on the order as a reference. We still need the complete details for the supplied item.
- 09 **Omar:** Would the full manufacturer's item code be more useful than my description of the packaging? I can ask the supplier for that information.
- 10 **Leila:** Yes, the ⁵ _____ and full label details will help us reconcile the delivery. Please keep the recorded measurement too; it remains useful information.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Omar:** I will keep it. Once the identity is clear, where do we look for the dimensions rather than guessing from the size name?
- 12 **Leila:** The matching manufacturer's ⁶ _____ is the appropriate reference. It must belong to the relevant product, not merely something with a similar description.
- 13 **Omar:** There is also a question from the site about whether the supplied component will join the specified item. Does the nominal designation answer that?
- 14 **Leila:** No. We still need the ⁷ _____ and relevant requirements. The size name alone does not establish that two components can be used together.
- 15 **Omar:** Understood. I should not describe the delivery as an approved alternative either, even if the supplier says the dimensions look close.
- 16 **Leila:** Correct. A ⁸ _____ needs its own review. We have not verified material or connection compatibility, and we have not accepted another product in place of the order.
- 17 **Omar:** Let me check the message: the different numbers do not prove the goods are wrong, but the incomplete label means we cannot confirm them yet.
- 18 **Leila:** Exactly. Keep the ⁹ _____ unchanged while I reconcile the details. Neither the numerical difference nor my explanation should be treated as a final product decision.
- 19 **Omar:** I will obtain the full label information and part number from the supplier, then send them with the order reference and recorded measurement.
- 20 **Leila:** Thank you. That gives us a proper basis to investigate the ¹⁰ _____. We can resolve the actual delivery question without relying on a misleading comparison.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. nominal size | 2. outside diameter | 3. product identification | 4. product series | 5. part number | 6. dimensional table | 7. connection type | 8. substitution | 9. acceptance status | 10. supply discrepancy

Clarify the comparison, retain the query

F Say it

Complete the supplier summary. Distinguish the designation from the measurement and preserve the missing identification.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

label / outside / nominal / unverified

Buyer: "The order gives a ¹ _____ size."

Coordinator: "Your measurement is the ² _____ diameter."

Buyer: "The delivery ³ _____ is incomplete."

Coordinator: "Compatibility remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. nominal | 2. outside | 3. label | 4. unverified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The same 450, two different origins

A Read the situation

03

Explain a dimension conflict by naming both reference surfaces and requesting a coordinated detail without inventing an offset.

Plumber Nia and cabinet coordinator Ben compare a bathroom layout with a cabinet drawing. The layout places the basin centerline 450 millimeters from the finished wall face. The cabinet drawing uses 450 millimeters from the framing face. Basin B2 is selected, but no coordinated rough-in detail is confirmed. The two references are different; no wall-finish thickness is supplied. They need a design clarification, not an assumed conversion or permission to install.

PEOPLE / Nia: Plumber | Ben: Cabinet coordinator

SHOW THE DIFFERENCE BEFORE PROPOSING A REMEDY

Two drawings may contain the same number and still describe different positions. State the origin and endpoint on each. Cross-trade coordination works better when the question identifies the mismatch without blaming the other drawing or quietly inventing a correction.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What reference does the bathroom layout use?

A The room center

B The finished wall face

C The framing face

D The cabinet door face

2. Why do the two 450-millimeter dimensions conflict?

A They use different units

B The basin has not been selected

C One is a confirmed pipe diameter

D They start from different reference surfaces

3. What is not supplied?

A The selected basin identifier

B The layout's stated number

C The existence of the cabinet drawing

D A confirmed coordinated rough-in detail

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

basin centerline

Reference line through the center of the basin.

IN USE locate the basin centerline

finished wall face

Exposed wall surface after the finish is applied.

IN USE measure from the finished wall face

framing face

Surface of the structural framing used as a reference.

IN USE reference the framing face

datum

Defined reference from which a dimension is taken.

IN USE identify the datum

dimension origin

Starting reference for a measurement.

IN USE confirm the dimension origin

dimension endpoint

Point to which a measurement extends.

IN USE identify the dimension endpoint

rough-in

Early provision of services before final fixtures or finishes.

IN USE coordinate the rough-in

rough-in detail

Drawing information defining relevant preliminary service positions.

IN USE confirm the rough-in detail

fixture schedule

List identifying specified fixtures and relevant information.

IN USE consult the fixture schedule

selected model

Product chosen for the project.

IN USE verify the selected model

layout drawing

Drawing showing intended arrangement of elements.

IN USE review the layout drawing

cabinet drawing

Drawing describing the cabinetry arrangement.

IN USE compare the cabinet drawing

Precision check

Both drawings use 450 millimeters, and both concern the basin centerline. The conflict is the origin: finished wall face versus framing face. The shared number does not remove that difference.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

wall build-up

Layers forming the wall assembly and its finish.

IN USE establish the wall build-up

finish thickness

Dimension occupied by the finishing layer or layers.

IN USE confirm the finish thickness

offset

Distance between two defined reference positions.

IN USE calculate a verified offset

alignment

Relative positioning along a common reference.

IN USE coordinate fixture alignment

interface

Meeting point between related building elements or trades.

IN USE resolve the cabinet interface

clearance

Required space between or around components.

IN USE verify the relevant clearance

design query

Request to clarify design information.

IN USE raise a design query

coordinated detail

Information reconciled across the relevant elements and trades.

IN USE issue a coordinated detail

drawing reference

Identifier of the drawing supporting a statement.

IN USE cite the drawing reference

assumed conversion

Unverified adjustment between reference systems.

IN USE avoid an assumed conversion

installation position

Location authorized for the actual installed item.

IN USE confirm the installation position

dimension readback

Spoken repetition of a dimension and its references.

IN USE give a dimension readback

Precision check

Basin B2 is selected, but selection alone does not confirm its coordinated service positions. Without the wall build-up and an approved detail, do not invent an offset or turn a clarification into installation authorization.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

STATE THE LAYOUT REFERENCE

"The layout measures from the finished wall face."

KEEP THE ENDPOINT

"Both dimensions run to the basin centerline."

IDENTIFY THE CONFLICT

"The origins differ even though the numbers match."

SEPARATE SELECTION FROM COORDINATION

"Basin B2 is selected; the rough-in detail is not confirmed."

STATE THE OTHER REFERENCE

"The cabinet drawing measures from the framing face."

PRESERVE THE NUMBER

"Both drawings state 450 millimeters."

AVOID AN ASSUMED OFFSET

"We do not have the wall-finish thickness."

ASK THE DESIGN QUESTION

"Which datum should the coordinated detail use?"

From ... to

Identifies both the origin and endpoint of a dimension.

Even though

Highlights why matching numbers do not settle the conflict.

Selected versus confirmed

Product choice and coordinated installation information are separate.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

KEEP THE ISSUE BOUNDED

"We are clarifying the reference, not selecting another basin."

AVOID SILENT CORRECTION

"I will not adjust either dimension by assumption."

RETAIN BOTH RECORDS

"The query should cite both drawings."

AVOID PREMATURE INSTRUCTION

"This query is not permission to install."

NAME THE INTERFACE

"The basin and cabinetry need one coordinated position."

REQUEST THE DETAIL

"Please confirm a coordinated rough-in detail."

STATE WHAT IS UNCHANGED

"The selected basin remains B2."

READ BACK THE WHOLE DIMENSION

"450 millimeters to the basin centerline, with the origin unresolved."

By assumption

Flags an unsupported calculation or adjustment.

Which datum?

Requests a specific design clarification rather than a vague correction.

Remains

Preserves an established fact while another issue is resolved.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

03

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which summary identifies the actual mismatch?

- A** One drawing uses inches and the other millimeters
- B** The client has selected two basins
- C** The drawings disagree about the centerline endpoint
- D** Both show 450 to the centerline, but one starts at the finished face and one at framing

2. Which proposed action is unsupported?

- A** Cite both drawing references in the query
- B** Retain B2 as the selected basin
- C** Ask for a coordinated rough-in detail
- D** Subtract an assumed finish thickness and release installation

3. What does selecting B2 establish?

- A** A verified wall build-up
- B** The chosen basin model, not a confirmed coordinated rough-in
- C** Every service position
- D** Approval of the cabinet datum

4. Which question is most precise?

- A** Why did the cabinet team choose the wrong basin?
- B** May we assume the two positions are identical?
- C** Which reference surface governs the coordinated centerline position?
- D** Can someone fix the drawings somehow?

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The same 450, two different origins

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

dimension readback / datum / fixture schedule / finish thickness / framing face / finished wall face / rough-in detail / coordinated detail / dimension origin / design query

- 01 **Nia:** Before we pass the bathroom information on, I need to resolve the basin position. Both drawings show 450, but they do not start in the same place.
- 02 **Ben:** I see that. The cabinet drawing starts at the ¹ _____. Does the bathroom layout use that same surface, or the completed wall surface?
- 03 **Nia:** It uses the completed surface. The dimension runs from the finished wall face to the centerline of the basin, not to its outside edge.
- 04 **Ben:** Then the ² _____ differs, even though the endpoint and the number appear to agree. We should make that explicit in the query.
- 05 **Nia:** Yes. I do not want someone to see two matching numbers and assume we have a coordinated position. The difference could be missed in a short email.
- 06 **Ben:** I will describe the layout as 450 millimeters from the ³ _____ to the basin centerline, then state the cabinet reference separately.
- 07 **Nia:** Keep the number unchanged in both descriptions. We are asking which reference should govern, not silently replacing one drawing with our own calculation.
- 08 **Ben:** Agreed. We do not have the ⁴ _____, so I cannot convert one dimension into the other and call the result confirmed.
- 09 **Nia:** The basin choice itself is settled. B2 is the selected model, and I do not want the question to reopen the product selection unnecessarily.
- 10 **Ben:** I will preserve B2 in the ⁵ _____ reference. Product selection and the location of the preliminary service provisions are separate pieces of information.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Nia:** Exactly. What we do not have is a confirmed detail showing how the plumbing position and cabinet arrangement work together for that basin.
- 12 **Ben:** Then we should request a ⁶ _____, with the datum clearly stated. The query should attach both drawing references so the designer can see the mismatch.
- 13 **Nia:** Would it help to write that both dimensions end at the basin centerline? Otherwise someone might answer a different question about the edge of the bowl.
- 14 **Ben:** Yes. A complete ⁷ _____ needs the number, origin, and endpoint. Here, the origin is unresolved; the centerline endpoint is already identified.
- 15 **Nia:** Can we also make clear that the question does not release the rough-in work? A copied email can otherwise start to sound like a direction.
- 16 **Ben:** Certainly. The ⁸ _____ is not confirmed. Asking for clarification does not authorize either team to use an assumed installation position.
- 17 **Nia:** Let me hear the short version you will send, including B2 and both surfaces. That should keep the request specific enough to answer.
- 18 **Ben:** Selected basin B2; both drawings show 450 millimeters to its centerline. Layout uses finished wall face; cabinet drawing uses framing face. Please resolve the ⁹ _____ and confirm the coordinated detail.
- 19 **Nia:** That captures it. No invented wall thickness, no revised basin choice, and no claim that the two positions are already the same.
- 20 **Ben:** I will submit that ¹⁰ _____ and keep the rough-in information unconfirmed until the relevant response is received and accepted through the project process.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. framing face | 2. dimension origin | 3. finished wall face | 4. finish thickness | 5. fixture schedule | 6. coordinated detail | 7. dimension readback | 8. rough-in detail | 9. datum | 10. design query

Read back both references

F Say it

Complete the coordination exchange. Keep the shared endpoint and number, but do not erase the different origins.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

framing / centerline / finished / unconfirmed

Plumber: "The layout starts at the ¹ _____ wall face."

Coordinator: "The cabinet drawing starts at the ² _____ face."

Plumber: "Both dimensions end at the basin ³ _____."

Coordinator: "The coordinated rough-in detail remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. finished | 2. framing | 3. centerline | 4. unconfirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A dry patch is not a diagnosis

A Read the situation

Report the observed condition with a time limit, acknowledge a customer concern, and avoid unsupported cause or repair claims.

Shop owner Rosa asks plumber Arun about a ceiling stain below an upstairs washroom. The visible patch is dry during the visit. No pipework is visible, and the source of the staining has not been established. Rosa asks whether the dry surface proves a leak has stopped. Arun must distinguish the visible condition from a diagnosis, preserve the location in the record, and explain that the source still needs assessment. No completed repair or structural assessment is supplied.

PEOPLE / Rosa: Shop owner | Arun: Plumber

GIVE A USEFUL LIMIT, NOT A VAGUE REFUSAL

A customer asking whether a problem has stopped often wants reassurance. Acknowledge that need, state what was actually observed, and explain what the observation cannot establish. Precise limits can remain courteous without sounding dismissive or alarmist.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What was observed during the visit?

- A** A repair had stopped a leak
- B** The upstairs basin was the source
- C** The visible ceiling patch was dry
- D** All concealed pipework was sound

2. What is not visible?

- A** The upstairs washroom's position
- B** The pipework
- C** The ceiling stain
- D** The shop location

3. What remains unresolved?

- A** Whether a stain exists
- B** Whether the patch was dry during the visit
- C** Whether Rosa asked a question
- D** The source of the staining

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

ceiling stain

Discoloration on a ceiling surface.

IN USE record the ceiling stain

visible patch

Area of surface condition available to observation.

IN USE describe the visible patch

surface condition

State of the exposed material at a given time.

IN USE report the surface condition

concealed pipework

Pipes hidden from view behind building finishes.

IN USE distinguish concealed pipework

washroom

Room containing washing or toilet facilities.

IN USE locate the upstairs washroom

moisture source

Origin of water or dampness affecting a location.

IN USE investigate the moisture source

dry at the visit

Without observed surface wetness during that attendance.

IN USE state dry at the visit

historical staining

Discoloration remaining from an earlier event.

IN USE distinguish historical staining

active leak

Water escape occurring at the relevant time.

IN USE establish an active leak

intermittent condition

Problem that occurs at intervals rather than continuously.

IN USE describe an intermittent condition

recurrence

Return of a previously reported condition.

IN USE record a recurrence

observation scope

Extent of what was actually seen or assessed.

IN USE define the observation scope

Precision check

Dry during the visit describes a surface and a time. It does not prove that no leak exists, that a previous leak has stopped, or that a particular concealed pipe caused the stain.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

time qualifier

Wording limiting a statement to a specified period.

IN USE retain the time qualifier

causal claim

Statement identifying why something happened.

IN USE avoid an unsupported causal claim

diagnosis

Determination of the nature or cause of a problem.

IN USE distinguish observation from diagnosis

assessment

Relevant examination or evaluation of a condition.

IN USE arrange an assessment

inspection limitation

Boundary on what could be examined.

IN USE explain the inspection limitation

repair claim

Statement that corrective work has been completed.

IN USE verify a repair claim

resolution

Established correction or closure of the reported issue.

IN USE avoid premature resolution

qualified statement

Statement with explicit limits on its meaning.

IN USE make a qualified statement

evidence

Information supporting a conclusion.

IN USE distinguish evidence from assumption

attribution

Identification of who supplied an account.

IN USE preserve attribution

client concern

Customer's question or worry about the condition.

IN USE acknowledge the client concern

finding summary

Concise account of established observations and limits.

IN USE give a finding summary

Precision check

The stain is below a washroom, but that location does not identify its source. Preserve the visible observation, concealed-pipework limit, and unresolved cause. No repair result or structural conclusion follows from this account.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"I understand why you want to know whether it has stopped."

KEEP THE TIME ATTACHED

"That statement applies to what is visible now."

AVOID A CAUSE CLAIM

"The source of the staining has not been established."

AVOID A REPAIR CLAIM

"I have no completed repair to report."

STATE THE OBSERVATION

"The visible patch is dry during this visit."

IDENTIFY THE LIMITATION

"No pipework is visible from this position."

SEPARATE LOCATION FROM ORIGIN

"Below the washroom describes location, not a proven source."

KEEP UNCERTAINTY SPECIFIC

"We cannot infer that a leak has stopped from this surface alone."

During this visit

Limits a statement in time rather than generalizing indefinitely.

Visible

Restricts the statement to what could be seen.

Below versus caused by

One describes position; the other assigns cause.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

RETAIN THE CUSTOMER ACCOUNT

"I will keep your concern in the record."

NAME THE NEXT NEED

"The source still needs assessment."

AVOID A BLANKET ASSURANCE

"I cannot confirm the concealed pipework's condition from this view."

CORRECT AN OVERSTATEMENT

"Please replace leak stopped with patch dry during visit."

AVOID DISMISSING THE STAIN

"The dry surface does not make the stain irrelevant."

DISTINGUISH SYMPTOM AND DIAGNOSIS

"A stain is an observation, not a diagnosis."

USE A BOUNDED SUMMARY

"Visible patch dry at the visit; source unresolved."

CLOSE WITHOUT INVENTED CERTAINTY

"I can report the observation, but not a confirmed resolution."

Does not prove

Rejects an inference without asserting the opposite.

Still needs assessment

Identifies a remaining task without predicting its outcome.

Cannot confirm

Marks a specific evidence limit, not disbelief in the customer.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement is best supported?

- A** The leak has definitely stopped
- B** The upstairs basin caused the stain
- C** The concealed pipework is fault-free
- D** The visible patch was dry during the visit; source unresolved

2. What is wrong with saying leak stopped?

- A** It infers a change in a leak that has not been established
- B** It uses too few words
- C** It preserves the observation time too carefully
- D** It identifies the patch location

3. Which phrase best communicates the inspection limit?

- A** All pipework was inspected
- B** The washroom was proved unrelated
- C** The entire structure was assessed
- D** No pipework was visible from this position

4. What should the report avoid?

- A** The location of the stain
- B** The dry surface observation
- C** The unresolved-source statement
- D** A repair or structural conclusion unsupported by the visit

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

A dry patch is not a diagnosis

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

surface condition / repair claim / observation scope / finding summary / time qualifier / moisture source / inspection limitation / qualified statement / visible patch / causal claim

- 01 **Rosa:** The stain is below the upstairs washroom, but the patch looks dry today. Can I tell the shop manager that the leak has stopped?
- 02 **Arun:** I can confirm the ¹ _____ we can see during this visit. I cannot turn that into confirmation that a leak has stopped.
- 03 **Rosa:** I see the distinction, but I need something more useful than we do not know. What can I accurately put in the manager's update?
- 04 **Arun:** Say the ² _____ is dry during the visit. Keep the time in the sentence, and add that the source of the staining has not been established.
- 05 **Rosa:** Does the fact that the washroom is directly above help us name the cause, or does that only describe where we found the stain?
- 06 **Arun:** It describes the location. It does not establish the ³ _____. No pipework is visible here, so we should not name a concealed component as responsible.
- 07 **Rosa:** I had been going to write that the basin upstairs must have leaked. I will leave that out unless there is an actual finding.
- 08 **Arun:** That is right. It would be a ⁴ _____, not a description of the ceiling. We need to keep those two kinds of statement separate.
- 09 **Rosa:** Could the dry patch at least mean that nothing is happening now? I am trying to explain the situation without making the update sound alarming.
- 10 **Arun:** The ⁵ _____ is the visible surface during this attendance. It does not establish the condition of hidden pipework or prove that an issue cannot recur.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

04

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Rosa:** Then it would also be wrong to say you checked all the pipes and found no problem. We have not seen them here.
- 12 **Arun:** Exactly. That would erase the ⁶ _____. The accurate record should say no pipework was visible, rather than imply that every relevant component was examined.
- 13 **Rosa:** I understand. There is no completed repair for me to mention either, is there? I do not want the manager to assume something was fixed.
- 14 **Arun:** Correct. There is no ⁷ _____ to make from these facts. We have an observation and an unresolved source, not a documented correction of the problem.
- 15 **Rosa:** Please help me make the final wording concise. I want it to sound clear, not as though I am avoiding the question.
- 16 **Arun:** Use a ⁸ _____: ceiling stain below the upstairs washroom; visible patch dry during the visit; source not established, with assessment still needed.
- 17 **Rosa:** That gives the location, what was seen, and what remains open. I will not shorten dry during the visit to no leak.
- 18 **Arun:** Good. The ⁹ _____ matters. Removing it could make a limited observation sound like a continuing assurance about the whole system.
- 19 **Rosa:** I will send that wording and keep the source question open. Thank you for explaining the difference without dismissing what we have noticed.
- 20 **Arun:** You are welcome. That ¹⁰ _____ is accurate and useful. It records the condition we can describe while leaving the cause for the appropriate assessment.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. surface condition | 2. visible patch | 3. moisture source | 4. causal claim | 5. observation scope | 6. inspection limitation | 7. repair claim | 8. qualified statement | 9. time qualifier | 10. finding summary

Correct the manager update

F Say it

Complete the concise report. Preserve the surface observation and the missing source assessment without implying a repair.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

established / dry / pipework / assessment

Owner: "The visible patch was ¹ _____ during the visit."

Plumber: "No ² _____ was visible."

Owner: "The source is not ³ _____."

Plumber: "The source still needs ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. dry | 2. pipework | 3. established | 4. assessment

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The panel is not an extra drain

A Read the situation

Explain a technical term in ordinary language and distinguish a design request from an approved change to service access.

05

Client Hana reviews a cabinet drawing with plumbing coordinator Dev. The drawing shows a small removable panel for access to a recorded cleanout. Hana calls it an extra drain and asks for it to be permanently covered. The plumber has not reviewed that enclosure change. The designer needs to coordinate the access detail with the plumbing team. No approved panel dimensions, replacement arrangement, or permission to conceal the cleanout is supplied.

PEOPLE / Hana: Client | Dev: Plumbing coordinator

EXPLAIN FUNCTION BEFORE DEFENDING TERMINOLOGY

A client may object to something because the label suggests the wrong function. Explain what the component does in everyday language, then describe the actual design question. Correcting a term does not require belittling the client or approving the requested change.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the removable panel provide?

A Access to the recorded cleanout

C A new water supply

B A second basin drain

D A decorative plumbing fixture

2. What has Hana requested?

A Replacement of the basin model

C Permanent covering of the panel area

B A new drain location already accepted

D Approval of a completed access review

3. Who needs to coordinate the detail?

A The client alone without review

C No one because the panel is decorative

B Only the furniture delivery driver

D The designer with the plumbing team

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

access panel

Removable or openable cover providing access behind a finish.

IN USE retain an access panel

cleanout

Fitting or opening provided for access to drainage piping for maintenance.

IN USE identify the recorded cleanout

drain

Opening or pipe carrying used water away.

IN USE distinguish the drain

drainage line

Pipe route conveying waste water or discharge.

IN USE locate the drainage line

waste outlet

Point through which used water leaves a fixture.

IN USE identify the waste outlet

service access

Means of reaching equipment or services for relevant work.

IN USE preserve service access

removable cover

Cover designed to be taken off through the proper procedure.

IN USE specify a removable cover

permanent enclosure

Construction intended to remain closed rather than provide removable access.

IN USE review a permanent enclosure

cabinet elevation

Drawing showing the vertical face of cabinetry.

IN USE read the cabinet elevation

access detail

Design information showing how services can be reached.

IN USE coordinate the access detail

maintenance

Work to preserve or restore a system's relevant condition.

IN USE allow for maintenance

clear opening

Unobstructed space available through an opening.

IN USE verify the clear opening

Precision check

The access panel is not a second drain. It provides a way to reach the recorded cleanout, which serves drainage-maintenance access. Explaining that function does not specify an acceptable panel size or enclosure arrangement.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

obstruction

Item that blocks a required route or space.

IN USE identify an obstruction

concealment

Covering that hides an element from view.

IN USE review proposed concealment

finish panel

Panel forming an exposed decorative surface.

IN USE coordinate the finish panel

fixed panel

Panel not intended to function as a removable access feature.

IN USE distinguish a fixed panel

hinged panel

Panel attached so that it can swing open.

IN USE identify a hinged panel

serviceable

Capable of receiving relevant maintenance under the required conditions.

IN USE verify a serviceable arrangement

design intent

Purpose or intended result of a design feature.

IN USE clarify the design intent

appearance request

Client preference about how something looks.

IN USE record the appearance request

enclosure change

Proposed alteration to the surrounding cover or construction.

IN USE review the enclosure change

access requirement

Condition that access must satisfy for the actual application.

IN USE establish the access requirement

review status

Stage of evaluation or acceptance.

IN USE confirm the review status

coordination response

Agreed answer from the relevant design and trade review.

IN USE await the coordination response

Precision check

Hana has requested permanent covering, but the plumber has not reviewed that change. Preserve the appearance preference as a request. Do not treat a small symbol on a drawing as proof that access can be removed.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE LABEL

"That symbol identifies an access panel, not an extra drain."

DEFINE THE SECOND TERM

"A cleanout provides maintenance access to the drainage piping."

SEPARATE REQUEST AND APPROVAL

"I can record that preference, but it is not an approved change."

AVOID INVENTING DIMENSIONS

"We do not have approved access dimensions here."

EXPLAIN THE FUNCTION

"It provides access to the recorded cleanout."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE APPEARANCE CONCERN

"I understand that you want a continuous cabinet finish."

NAME THE UNREVIEWED ITEM

"The proposed permanent enclosure has not been reviewed by the plumber."

KEEP FUNCTION DISTINCT

"Hiding a component and preserving access are different questions."

Provides access to

Explains function without giving instructions to open or use the component.

Not an extra drain

Corrects the specific misunderstanding rather than criticizing the speaker.

Would like versus will

Separates preference from a confirmed design commitment.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

NAME THE COORDINATOR

"The designer needs to coordinate this with the plumbing team."

AVOID A CASUAL ASSURANCE

"I cannot confirm that permanent covering is acceptable."

DISTINGUISH THE PANEL TYPES

"A fixed finish panel is not automatically an access panel."

PRESERVE THE STATUS

"The enclosure change remains unapproved."

ASK FOR THE ACTUAL DETAIL

"Please confirm how the required access will be provided."

KEEP ALTERNATIVES CONDITIONAL

"Any alternative arrangement needs the relevant review."

RECORD THE PREFERENCE

"The client requests a less visible panel arrangement."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"We will seek a coordinated access detail before confirming a change."

Has not been reviewed

States the missing evaluation, not an automatic rejection.

Any alternative

Keeps every proposed replacement subject to the relevant requirements.

Before confirming

Makes review a condition of a later commitment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which explanation is clearest?

- A** A small panel never needs review
- B** The panel lets the relevant team reach the cleanout; it is not another drain
- C** The panel drains the cabinet
- D** The cleanout is merely decorative

2. What should Dev do with Hana's preference?

- A** Record it for design coordination without approving concealment
- B** Promise permanent covering immediately
- C** Remove the cleanout from the record
- D** Treat the preference as a completed plumbing review

3. Which claim is unsupported?

- A** The plumber has not reviewed the change
- B** The drawn panel dimensions are approved and sufficient
- C** The drawing shows a removable panel
- D** The client wants a continuous finish

4. What is the appropriate next step?

- A** Assume all removable covers are interchangeable
- B** Coordinate the access detail with the designer and plumbing team
- C** Give the client instructions to dismantle the panel
- D** Approve a fixed cover based on appearance

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The panel is not an extra drain

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

access requirement / clear opening / cleanout / coordination response / design intent / fixed panel / access detail / access panel / appearance request / review status

- 01 **Hana:** On this cabinet drawing, why is there an extra drain in the front panel? I would prefer a continuous finish across that whole section.
- 02 **Dev:** The marked feature is an ¹ _____, rather than an additional drain. It provides access to a recorded plumbing component behind the cabinet finish.
- 03 **Hana:** That makes more sense. The label says cleanout, which is not a word I use. Is that another name for the basin outlet?
- 04 **Dev:** No. A ² _____ provides access to drainage piping for maintenance. The basin outlet and this access feature should not be treated as the same thing.
- 05 **Hana:** I understand the function now. Could we permanently cover the front anyway? I would rather not have a visible break in the cabinet face.
- 06 **Dev:** I can record that ³ _____, but the plumber has not reviewed the enclosure change. I cannot confirm permanent covering as an acceptable arrangement.
- 07 **Hana:** I am not asking to change the drainage route. I am asking whether the cabinet can look continuous while keeping whatever access is needed.
- 08 **Dev:** That is a clearer design question. The designer needs to coordinate the ⁴ _____ with the plumbing team, including how the relevant component can be reached.
- 09 **Hana:** Does the small rectangle on the drawing tell us the opening is already large enough? It looks quite small compared with the cabinet door.
- 10 **Dev:** Not from this information. We do not have an approved ⁵ _____ or a confirmed replacement arrangement. The symbol alone cannot establish that a particular access solution is sufficient.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Hana:** Then I should not tell the cabinet maker to replace the removable part with a fixed decorative panel just because it looks cleaner.
- 12 **Dev:** Correct. A ⁶ _____ is not automatically equivalent to the removable feature. We need the access requirements resolved before anyone confirms that change.
- 13 **Hana:** Could the design team consider something less visible without assuming that I have demanded a specific technical solution? I am open to their advice.
- 14 **Dev:** Yes. We can record your preference separately from the ⁷ _____. Any alternative still needs review; I am not promising a particular panel type or location.
- 15 **Hana:** Please make the request specific. I do not want the next drawing to remove the access entirely because my first email called it an extra drain.
- 16 **Dev:** I will clarify the ⁸ _____ in the note: the feature provides access to a cleanout, and the client asks for a less visible arrangement.
- 17 **Hana:** That accurately describes what I want. Who needs to respond before I can regard the cabinet appearance as settled?
- 18 **Dev:** We need the designer and plumbing team to provide a ⁹ _____. Until then, the permanent-enclosure proposal remains unapproved and the access question stays open.
- 19 **Hana:** All right. I will describe this as an access-detail review, not a request to delete a drain or an instruction to cover the opening.
- 20 **Dev:** Thank you. That keeps the ¹⁰ _____ clear while giving the design team an answerable question about appearance and access, without authorizing an unreviewed alteration.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. access panel | 2. cleanout | 3. appearance request | 4. access detail | 5. clear opening | 6. fixed panel | 7. access requirement | 8. design intent | 9. coordination response | 10. review status

Explain the panel and the pending review

F Say it

Complete the client exchange. Name the access feature and preserve the approval boundary.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

drain / detail / cleanout / approved

Client: "The panel is not an extra ¹ _____."

Coordinator: "It provides access to a ² _____."

Client: "The designer will coordinate the access ³ _____."

Coordinator: "Permanent covering is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. drain | 2. cleanout | 3. detail | 4. approved

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Arrival at nine, proposed interruption at ten

A Read the situation

Correct a notice by separating attendance time, affected area, proposed interruption window, and pending approval.

06

Service coordinator Imani speaks with tenant representative Joel about a plumbing visit booked for 09:00. A water interruption is proposed for 10:00-11:00, pending building-manager approval. The stated affected area is the east washroom only. Joel thinks the whole building will be unavailable from 09:00. Imani must correct both the extent and the timing without presenting the proposed interruption as confirmed. The conversation supplies no instruction to operate valves or begin work.

PEOPLE / Imani: Service coordinator | Joel: Tenant representative

SEPARATE THE CLOCKS AND THE COMMITMENTS

A visit, an interruption, and a room-access arrangement can appear in one message but have different times and approval states. Give each its own sentence. Correcting one misunderstanding must not leave another in place or make a proposal sound booked.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is booked for 09:00?

A A completed valve operation

C A whole-building shutdown

B The plumbing visit

D The end of the interruption

2. What is the proposed interruption window?

A 09:00-10:00 already approved

C 09:00-11:00

B 10:00-11:00

D All day

3. What is the stated affected area?

A The whole building

C The west washroom only

B Every washroom

D The east washroom only

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

attendance time

Time scheduled for the service team to arrive.

IN USE confirm the attendance time

interruption window

Defined period proposed or agreed for a service interruption.

IN USE state the interruption window

affected area

Location included in the stated impact.

IN USE identify the affected area

east washroom

Particular room identified by its east-side location.

IN USE specify the east washroom

building manager

Person responsible for relevant building coordination.

IN USE seek building-manager approval

tenant representative

Person communicating on behalf of occupants.

IN USE brief the tenant representative

proposed interruption

Suggested service pause not yet confirmed.

IN USE describe the proposed interruption

approved interruption

Service pause accepted through the relevant approval process.

IN USE distinguish an approved interruption

booking confirmation

Record establishing an agreed appointment.

IN USE read the booking confirmation

notice wording

Text used to inform affected people.

IN USE correct the notice wording

impact scope

Extent of the service or area affected.

IN USE define the impact scope

pending approval

Awaiting a required acceptance decision.

IN USE retain pending-approval status

Precision check

The visit is booked for 09:00. The interruption is proposed for 10:00-11:00, with building-manager approval pending. Do not move the interruption to the arrival time or call the proposal confirmed.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

start time

Beginning of a defined event or period.

IN USE preserve the start time

end time

Finish of a defined event or period.

IN USE state the end time

room availability

Whether a room is available under stated conditions.

IN USE clarify room availability

access arrangement

Agreed means or conditions for reaching a work area.

IN USE coordinate the access arrangement

occupant communication

Information provided to people using the premises.

IN USE prepare occupant communication

whole-building claim

Statement that the entire premises is affected.

IN USE correct a whole-building claim

confirmed appointment

Visit that has been booked rather than merely suggested.

IN USE distinguish the confirmed appointment

operating instruction

Direction to act on equipment or a system.

IN USE distinguish an operating instruction

schedule readback

Repetition of times, scope, and status for confirmation.

IN USE give a schedule readback

status qualifier

Wording identifying certainty or approval stage.

IN USE preserve the status qualifier

notice release

Authorization to issue the relevant communication.

IN USE confirm notice release

coordination update

New information about arrangements and outstanding decisions.

IN USE provide a coordination update

06

Precision check

The east washroom is the stated affected area, not the whole building. The corrected wording must preserve both scope and status. This scheduling conversation is not authorization to operate valves or start an interruption.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

SEPARATE THE APPOINTMENT

"The visit is booked for 09:00."

LIMIT THE AREA

"The stated affected area is the east washroom only."

CORRECT THE FIRST MISUNDERSTANDING

"Arrival at 09:00 does not mean interruption at 09:00."

KEEP THE PROPOSAL VISIBLE

"Please retain proposed in the notice."

STATE THE PROPOSED WINDOW

"The proposed interruption is 10:00-11:00."

NAME THE APPROVAL

"Building-manager approval is still pending."

CORRECT THE SECOND MISUNDERSTANDING

"The proposal does not cover the whole building."

AVOID OVERSTATING CERTAINTY

"We cannot describe that window as confirmed yet."

06

Booked versus proposed

Identifies two different levels of commitment.

Only

Restricts the stated impact to the named area.

From ... to

Supplies both endpoints of a time window.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

GIVE SEPARATE SENTENCES

"Put the visit time and interruption window on separate lines."

PRESERVE THE BOOKED ITEM

"The attendance booking remains at 09:00."

DISTINGUISH NOTICE AND ACTION

"This message is not an operating instruction."

KEEP RELEASE SEPARATE

"The final notice still needs the relevant release process."

READ BACK BOTH ENDPOINTS

"The proposed start is 10:00 and the proposed end is 11:00."

AVOID INVENTED ACCESS TERMS

"Separate room-access arrangements still need their actual coordination."

NAME THE CORRECTION

"We need to correct timing, area, and approval status."

CLOSE WITH A PRECISE UPDATE

"Visit booked; east-washroom interruption proposed; approval pending."

06

Still pending

Makes the unresolved approval visible after other details are corrected.

Does not mean

Blocks an inference from arrival time to service interruption.

Separate lines

Helps readers avoid combining distinct events into one schedule.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which notice wording preserves all supplied facts?

- A** Visit proposed at 11:00, interruption approved
- B** Visit 09:00; east-washroom interruption proposed 10:00-11:00, pending approval
- C** Whole building closed from 09:00
- D** East washroom interruption confirmed from 09:00

2. What is wrong with only changing whole building to east washroom?

- A** It removes the correct building name
- B** It changes an approved interruption to a proposal
- C** It supplies too much technical detail
- D** Timing and approval status may still be wrong

3. Which item is already confirmed?

- A** The proposed interruption
- B** The whole-building effect
- C** Valve operating permission
- D** The 09:00 visit booking

4. What should Joel avoid treating the message as?

- A** Permission to operate valves or start an interruption
- B** A correction of the area
- C** A statement of the proposed window
- D** A clarification of attendance time

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Arrival at nine, proposed interruption at ten

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

affected area / building manager / access arrangement / status qualifier / coordination update / notice wording / schedule readback / operating instruction / interruption window / attendance time

- 01 **Joel:** I was about to tell the tenants the whole building will be unavailable from nine. That is when the plumbing team is booked, correct?
- 02 **Imani:** The ¹ _____ is 09:00, yes. But that is not the proposed start of the water interruption, and the proposal does not cover the whole building.
- 03 **Joel:** Thank you for stopping me. I have combined the arrival and the interruption into one message. What are the two times I should keep separate?
- 04 **Imani:** The visit is booked for nine. The proposed ² _____ is 10:00-11:00. Those are separate events, and they also have different approval states.
- 05 **Joel:** Before we get to approval, can you confirm the area named in the proposal? I should correct the whole-building wording as well.
- 06 **Imani:** The stated ³ _____ is the east washroom only. Please keep that room name attached to the proposed interruption rather than describing every area as unavailable.
- 07 **Joel:** So I can write east washroom unavailable from ten to eleven, with the visit at nine. Does that now accurately capture the arrangement?
- 08 **Imani:** It still needs the ⁴ _____. The interruption is proposed, not confirmed, because building-manager approval is pending. Your revised sentence currently sounds like a firm arrangement.
- 09 **Joel:** I see. Correcting the room and the times is not enough if I drop the fact that someone still has to approve the interruption.
- 10 **Imani:** Exactly. The ⁵ _____ has not approved that proposal yet. We need both the accurate details and the accurate level of certainty in the communication.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Joel:** Would separate lines help? One for the booked visit, then another for the proposed interruption with the room and approval note together?
- 12 **Imani:** Yes. That would improve the ⁶ _____ and make the distinction easier to scan. Keep 09:00 with attendance and 10:00-11:00 with the proposed east-washroom interruption.
- 13 **Joel:** I will not add a wider room-access arrangement from my own assumptions. That needs its actual coordination rather than a guess based on the visit.
- 14 **Imani:** Correct. We should not invent an ⁷ _____ in this correction. We are clarifying the supplied timing, impact, and approval status, not adding new permissions.
- 15 **Joel:** Let me read it back: visit booked for 09:00. East-washroom water interruption proposed for 10:00-11:00, with building-manager approval still pending.
- 16 **Imani:** That ⁸ _____ is accurate. It fixes the earlier whole-building claim without turning the interruption into a confirmed event.
- 17 **Joel:** When that wording is reviewed, it will be a tenant notice, not a direction for anyone to begin the interruption or operate equipment.
- 18 **Imani:** Precisely. It is not an ⁹ _____. Actual operations and the release of the final notice must follow their separate relevant processes.
- 19 **Joel:** I will replace the earlier draft with the corrected wording and keep the approval note visible. I will not tell tenants the window is confirmed.
- 20 **Imani:** Thank you. That gives us a clear ¹⁰ _____: booked visit, limited proposed interruption, and a named approval still outstanding. Those distinctions should remain in any later summary.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. attendance time | 2. interruption window | 3. affected area | 4. status qualifier | 5. building manager | 6. notice wording | 7. access arrangement | 8. schedule readback | 9. operating instruction | 10. coordination update

Separate the two times

F Say it

Complete the corrected schedule notice. Preserve the room limit and the proposal status.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

east / 10:00-11:00 / 09:00 / pending

Coordinator: "The visit is booked for ¹ _____."

Representative: "The interruption is proposed for ² _____."

Coordinator: "It concerns the ³ _____ washroom only."

Representative: "Building-manager approval remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. 09:00 | 2. 10:00-11:00 | 3. east | 4. pending

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A fixture allowance is not a vanity package

A Read the situation

Explain the limits of an estimate, separate a product allowance from related work, and request a revised scope before confirming terms.

Client Ava discusses an estimate with plumbing estimator Luis. The estimate covers replacing basin B1 with the specified model. Ava now wants a wall-hung vanity and assumes the fixture allowance includes cabinet changes and redecoration, neither of which appears in the estimate. Access requirements and the revised plumbing scope have not been assessed. Luis must explain the original coverage, record the change request, and avoid quoting an unsupported extra cost or completion date.

PEOPLE / Ava: Client | Luis: Plumbing estimator

07

EXPLAIN THE DOCUMENT, NOT THE CUSTOMER FAULT

A customer may read an allowance as a complete package. Point to what the estimate actually includes, acknowledge the desired change, and distinguish the additional questions. Clear boundaries need not sound defensive or imply that every related cost has already been calculated.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does the current estimate cover?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A Every possible access repair | B Replacing B1 with the specified basin model |
| C A complete wall-hung vanity installation package | D Cabinet changes and redecoration |

2. What is Ava assuming?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A Luis has supplied a new completion date | B The fixture allowance includes cabinet changes and redecoration |
| C The original model has no identifier | D A revised assessment is complete |

3. What remains unassessed?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A The existence of the original estimate | B Ava's request for a wall-hung vanity |
| C The fact that B1 is the original fixture | D Access requirements and revised plumbing scope |

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

estimate

Stated assessment of expected cost for defined work.

IN USE review the estimate

fixture allowance

Amount allocated for a fixture within the stated estimate terms.

IN USE clarify the fixture allowance

specified model

Product identified in the agreed or proposed scope.

IN USE retain the specified model

basin replacement

Work to replace the identified basin.

IN USE define the basin replacement

wall-hung vanity

Vanity assembly supported from a wall rather than standing on the floor.

IN USE assess the wall-hung vanity request

cabinet alteration

Change to the cabinetry arrangement or construction.

IN USE price cabinet alterations

redcoration

Renewal of decorative finishes.

IN USE distinguish redecoration

making good

Restoring affected surfaces after work, within an agreed scope.

IN USE define making good

access requirements

Conditions or provisions needed to reach the work.

IN USE assess access requirements

revised scope

Updated description of work after a change.

IN USE agree the revised scope

scope inclusion

Item expressly covered by the stated work.

IN USE identify scope inclusions

scope exclusion

Item expressly left outside the stated work.

IN USE check scope exclusions

Precision check

The estimate covers the specified replacement of B1. The fixture allowance does not establish that cabinet alterations and redecoration are included. Explain the actual document instead of treating an allowance as a complete project package.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

unlisted work

Work not described in the current estimate.

IN USE identify unlisted work

change request

Proposal to alter the existing scope or selection.

IN USE record a change request

additional cost

Cost beyond the amount already stated.

IN USE assess additional cost

revised quotation

Updated price proposal for a defined changed scope.

IN USE prepare a revised quotation

commercial terms

Conditions concerning price, timing, and agreement.

IN USE confirm commercial terms

completion date

Date agreed or proposed for finishing defined work.

IN USE confirm the completion date

trade coordination

Alignment of work between the relevant specialists.

IN USE arrange trade coordination

scope boundary

Limit separating included work from other work.

IN USE explain the scope boundary

price assumption

Belief about cost not yet confirmed in the agreement.

IN USE correct a price assumption

restoration boundary

Limit of any agreed surface reinstatement.

IN USE clarify the restoration boundary

client selection

Product or arrangement chosen by the customer.

IN USE record the client selection

approval to proceed

Authorization to carry out the agreed work.

IN USE obtain approval to proceed

Precision check

The wall-hung vanity request changes the arrangement. Access requirements and revised plumbing work remain unassessed. Do not invent the cost, required construction, restoration extent, or completion date before that assessment and agreement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

STATE THE ORIGINAL COVERAGE

"The estimate covers replacement of B1 with the specified model."

CLARIFY THE ALLOWANCE

"The fixture allowance has the scope stated in this estimate."

AVOID BLAME

"I can see why you read that as a complete package."

KEEP ACCESS OPEN

"We have not assessed the access requirements for the new arrangement."

IDENTIFY THE NEW REQUEST

"You are now asking for a wall-hung vanity."

NAME THE UNLISTED WORK

"Cabinet changes and redecoration are not listed here."

SEPARATE THE TASKS

"Product supply, plumbing work, and restoration need distinct scope descriptions."

KEEP THE PLUMBING SCOPE OPEN

"The revised plumbing scope also needs assessment."

Covers

Identifies the actual stated work, not everything associated with the room.

Not listed

Describes a document limit without inventing another contract term.

Now asking for

Marks a change from the original arrangement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID AN INVENTED EXTRA

"I cannot give you a reliable additional figure yet."

RECORD THE REQUEST

"I will record the wall-hung vanity as a change request."

CLARIFY MAKING GOOD

"Any making-good work needs its own stated extent."

KEEP APPROVAL SEPARATE

"This discussion is not approval to proceed with extra work."

AVOID A DATE PROMISE

"We have not confirmed completion timing for the changed work."

ASK FOR THE REVISED BASIS

"We need a defined scope before confirming the revised price."

PRESERVE THE ORIGINAL REFERENCE

"The current estimate remains our reference for the original replacement."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STAGE

"We will assess the changed scope and then confirm revised terms."

Before confirming

Makes scope definition a condition of a reliable commitment.

Any making good

Avoids assuming all restoration is included or already priced.

Reliable figure

Explains why a price cannot responsibly be supplied before assessment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which response best addresses Ava's assumption?

- A** The wall-hung vanity has already been installed
- B** No plumbing assessment is needed for any vanity change
- C** The estimate covers B1 replacement; cabinet changes and redecoration are not listed
- D** All related work is automatically covered by an allowance

2. What must happen before revised terms can be confirmed?

- A** Treat the product preference as installation approval
- B** Assess access requirements and define the revised scope
- C** Reuse the original date automatically
- D** Assume all cabinet work is free

3. Which phrase overpromises?

- A** We need to define any making-good work
- B** The wall-hung vanity will cost exactly the same and finish on the original date
- C** I will record the change request
- D** Cabinet changes are not listed here

4. What does making good need in an agreement?

- A** An assumption that every surface is included
- B** A guessed repair method
- C** No connection to the scope
- D** A defined extent of restoration

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

A fixture allowance is not a vanity package

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

additional cost / approval to proceed / making good / estimate / fixture allowance / completion date / revised quotation / change request / access requirements / cabinet alteration

- 01 **Ava:** I would like to change the basin replacement to a wall-hung vanity. I assumed the fixture allowance covered the cabinet changes and repainting around it.
- 02 **Luis:** The current ¹ _____ covers replacing B1 with the specified basin model. Cabinet changes and redecoration are not listed, so we need to separate those from the original work.
- 03 **Ava:** I read the allowance as a budget for the whole area, not just the fixture described. Is that where my reading went wrong?
- 04 **Luis:** I can see how that happened. The ² _____ must be read with the scope stated in the estimate. It does not establish a complete vanity-and-decoration package here.
- 05 **Ava:** I still prefer the wall-hung arrangement. Can we keep that as my request without assuming I have accepted a new price already?
- 06 **Luis:** Certainly. I will record a ³ _____ for the wall-hung vanity. We then need to assess what changes in the plumbing work and the related arrangements.
- 07 **Ava:** What is missing before you can tell me the difference in cost? I would like to understand why a quick fixture-price comparison is not enough.
- 08 **Luis:** We have not assessed the ⁴ _____ or the revised plumbing scope. The product price alone does not tell us what work the new arrangement requires.
- 09 **Ava:** Does that mean you are already saying extra cabinet construction is definitely required, or only that the current estimate does not include those changes?
- 10 **Luis:** Only the second is established here. A ⁵ _____ is not listed in the current estimate; I am not inventing a construction requirement before the arrangement is assessed.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Ava:** That is helpful. I also want any affected surfaces to look finished afterward. I have heard people call that making good.
- 12 **Luis:** Yes, but ⁶ _____ needs a clear stated extent. We should not assume it includes every cabinet change or all redecoration without describing and pricing the relevant work.
- 13 **Ava:** Could you give me a firm extra amount now and revise the details later? It would help me decide whether to keep the new idea.
- 14 **Luis:** I cannot give a reliable ⁷ _____ before the scope is assessed. A guessed figure could make the decision look simpler now and create a misunderstanding later.
- 15 **Ava:** Fair enough. Does the original completion date carry over automatically, or should I regard timing as another point to confirm for the change?
- 16 **Luis:** Timing also needs review. The ⁸ _____ for the changed work is not confirmed. We need to define the work and coordinate it before promising the revised terms.
- 17 **Ava:** Then the next document should show what the plumbing work covers, what happens to the cabinet and finishes, and what is outside the price.
- 18 **Luis:** Exactly. A ⁹ _____ should make those boundaries clear. The original estimate remains the reference for the specified B1 replacement, not evidence that the new package is included.
- 19 **Ava:** Please proceed with assessing the request, but do not treat this conversation as my approval for unpriced additional installation work.
- 20 **Luis:** Understood. There is no ¹⁰ _____ with the extra work. We will assess the changed scope, state the price and timing, and obtain the relevant agreement before treating them as commitments.

07

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. estimate | 2. fixture allowance | 3. change request | 4. access requirements | 5. cabinet alteration | 6. making good | 7. additional cost | 8. completion date | 9. revised quotation | 10. approval to proceed

State what is and is not priced

F Say it

Complete the estimate discussion. Preserve the original scope and the need to assess the changed arrangement.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

B1 / assessment / confirmed / redecoration

Estimator: "The estimate covers replacement of ¹ _____ with the specified model."

Client: "Cabinet changes and ² _____ are not listed."

Estimator: "The revised scope still needs ³ _____."

Client: "Price and timing are not yet ⁴ _____ for the change."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. B1 | 2. redecoration | 3. assessment | 4. confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The wrong leaflet and an unbooked visit

A Read the situation

Acknowledge received records, identify a model mismatch, and separate a promised update from an unconfirmed return appointment.

At handover, client Maya receives a pack for basin B1, but the care leaflet belongs to the previous model. Service lead Leo takes responsibility for obtaining the replacement leaflet and promises to call on Monday. A separate cosmetic-trim review requires a return visit, but no date is booked. Maya and Leo must keep the document correction and visit arrangement distinct. Receipt of the pack does not make its mismatched leaflet appropriate for the current model.

PEOPLE / Maya: Client | Leo: Service lead

08

CLOSE THE CONVERSATION WITHOUT CLOSING UNFINISHED WORK

A handover can include received documents and open items at the same time. Name each unfinished item, assign an owner, and distinguish a communication date from a visit date. A polite closing should not erase a remaining mismatch or imply everything is complete.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What is wrong with the care leaflet?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A It books the return visit | B It changes the warranty terms |
| C It belongs to the previous model | D It is confirmed for B1's current model |

2. What does Leo promise for Monday?

- | | |
|--|-------------------------------------|
| A Completion of every open item | B A replacement installation |
| C A call about follow-up | D A confirmed return visit |

3. What remains unscheduled?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A The identification of Leo as owner | B The return visit for cosmetic-trim review |
| C The Monday call commitment | D The fact that the pack was received |

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

handover pack

Collection of records supplied when work is handed over.

IN USE receive the handover pack

care leaflet

Product information describing relevant care instructions.

IN USE obtain the correct care leaflet

model mismatch

Difference between the product identified and the document supplied.

IN USE record the model mismatch

previous model

Product version or selection used before the current one.

IN USE distinguish the previous model

current model

Product now relevant to the installation or record.

IN USE identify the current model

replacement document

Correct document supplied in place of an unsuitable one.

IN USE request the replacement document

product record

Information identifying the relevant supplied or installed item.

IN USE reconcile the product record

document receipt

Acknowledgment that records have been delivered.

IN USE confirm document receipt

document correction

Amendment or replacement needed to make records accurate.

IN USE track the document correction

care guidance

Instructions relevant to maintaining the specified product.

IN USE use model-specific care guidance

cosmetic trim

Finishing piece primarily associated with appearance at an interface.

IN USE review the cosmetic trim

return visit

Further attendance at the premises.

IN USE arrange the return visit

Precision check

The handover pack was received, but the care leaflet belongs to the previous model. Receiving documents does not verify that every document matches the installed product. Keep the model mismatch open until corrected.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

visit booking

Confirmed appointment for attendance.

IN USE distinguish a visit booking

follow-up owner

Person responsible for progressing the open item.

IN USE name the follow-up owner

callback

Return phone call to provide information or an update.

IN USE commit to a callback

update date

Date promised for further communication.

IN USE confirm the update date

outstanding item

Matter not yet completed or resolved.

IN USE retain an outstanding item

open-item list

Record of matters still requiring action.

IN USE maintain the open-item list

completion claim

Statement that relevant work is finished.

IN USE verify a completion claim

closeout

Process of resolving and documenting remaining project matters.

IN USE manage closeout

warranty record

Document stating relevant warranty information.

IN USE retain the warranty record

service record

Account of attendance and work performed.

IN USE update the service record

handover readback

Repetition of received records and outstanding actions.

IN USE give a handover readback

status update

Communication reporting progress or current position.

IN USE provide a status update

08

Precision check

Leo owns the leaflet follow-up and promises a Monday call. The separate cosmetic-trim review needs a return visit with no date booked. Monday is not a promised visit, repair completion, or change to warranty terms.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE RECEIPT

"You have received the handover pack for B1."

KEEP THE DOCUMENT SPECIFIC

"We need the leaflet for the current model."

NAME THE CORRECTION

"I will obtain the replacement care document."

COMMIT TO COMMUNICATION

"I will call you on Monday."

IDENTIFY THE MISMATCH

"The care leaflet belongs to the previous model."

AVOID APPLYING THE WRONG GUIDANCE

"I cannot treat that leaflet as confirmed guidance for this model."

ACCEPT OWNERSHIP

"I will take responsibility for the leaflet follow-up."

SEPARATE THE VISIT

"The cosmetic-trim review needs a return visit."

08

Received versus correct

Document delivery and document accuracy are different facts.

For the current model

Links care information to the actual product.

Will call

Commits to communication, not to completing all outstanding work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

STATE THE BOOKING LIMIT

"No return date is booked yet."

KEEP BOTH ITEMS VISIBLE

"The leaflet and the trim visit are separate open items."

PRESERVE THE RECORDS

"The service and warranty records retain their actual terms."

NAME THE REMAINING ARRANGEMENT

"The return visit still needs scheduling."

CORRECT THE INFERENCE

"Monday is the callback date, not a site appointment."

AVOID CLAIMING COMPLETION

"I cannot mark either item complete merely because we have discussed it."

READ BACK THE HANDOVER

"Pack received; leaflet mismatch open; Leo to call Monday."

CLOSE WITH A CLEAR COMMITMENT

"I will update you without promising an unconfirmed outcome."

08

Not yet booked

Describes the appointment status without inventing a date.

Separate open items

Prevents one follow-up action from hiding another.

Without promising

Preserves a useful commitment while limiting unsupported outcomes.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover summary is accurate?

- A** Pack received; wrong-model leaflet pending replacement; Leo calls Monday; trim visit unbooked
- B** All documents verified and all work complete
- C** Return visit confirmed for Monday
- D** Warranty extended automatically until a visit

2. What would turn the callback into an unsupported promise?

- A** Keeping the trim review on the open-item list
- B** Telling Maya the team will attend on Monday
- C** Confirming Leo will call Monday
- D** Recording the leaflet mismatch

3. Which action best handles the leaflet mismatch?

- A** Assume similar products use identical guidance
- B** Treat delivery as verification
- C** Replace the model identifier by guesswork
- D** Obtain the document for the current model

4. What is not changed by this conversation?

- A** The need to correct the leaflet
- B** Leo's follow-up ownership
- C** The record of the Monday call
- D** The actual warranty terms

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The wrong leaflet and an unbooked visit

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

handover readback / model mismatch / follow-up owner / completion claim / Document receipt / replacement document / open-item list / warranty record / callback / update date

08

- 01 **Maya:** I have received the pack for B1, but this care leaflet appears to be for the old basin model. Can we check that before handover is closed?
- 02 **Leo:** Yes. There is a ¹ _____ in that leaflet. The pack has been delivered, but we should not treat the wrong document as confirmed guidance for the current model.
- 03 **Maya:** I do not want to assume the instructions are identical just because the two basins look similar. I would prefer the actual document for this one.
- 04 **Leo:** That is the right distinction. I will obtain the ² _____ for the current model rather than ask you to rely on an unverified equivalent.
- 05 **Maya:** Who should I contact if the new leaflet has not arrived? It would help to have one named person responsible for that item.
- 06 **Leo:** I will be the ³ _____ for the leaflet. Please record me against it, and I will call you on Monday with an update.
- 07 **Maya:** Thank you. There is also the cosmetic trim that needs review. Does Monday mean someone will return to look at that as well?
- 08 **Leo:** No. Monday is the ⁴ _____. The cosmetic-trim review needs a return visit, but we do not have a date booked for that attendance.
- 09 **Maya:** I had nearly put Monday into our site calendar as a visit. I will leave it as a call instead and keep the visit separate.
- 10 **Leo:** Please do. A ⁵ _____ is not a site appointment. I can commit to the Monday call without pretending the return visit has already been arranged.



The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Maya:** In the handover notes, should I list the leaflet and trim together as one general outstanding item, or give them separate entries?
- 12 **Leo:** Give them separate entries on the ⁶ _____. One concerns the correct document; the other concerns a review requiring further attendance. Combining them could hide an unfinished action.
- 13 **Maya:** That makes sense. Receiving the pack is one completed step, but it does not mean the incorrect leaflet has somehow been accepted as right.
- 14 **Leo:** Exactly. ⁷ _____ and document accuracy are different. We can acknowledge delivery while keeping the care-leaflet mismatch open until the proper document is supplied.
- 15 **Maya:** I also do not want the note to say the trim has been corrected merely because we have agreed that someone should review it.
- 16 **Leo:** Agreed. That would be an unsupported ⁸ _____. The review remains outstanding, and there is no return date to report yet.
- 17 **Maya:** Will anything about this follow-up change the warranty record, or should I keep the actual terms in the documents separate from these arrangements?
- 18 **Leo:** Keep the ⁹ _____ and its actual terms. This conversation assigns follow-up and clarifies scheduling; it does not create a new warranty promise.
- 19 **Maya:** Let me summarize: pack received, care leaflet for the wrong model, Leo owns its replacement and calls Monday. Trim review needs a return visit with no date booked.
- 20 **Leo:** That ¹⁰ _____ is accurate. It lets us finish this discussion with clear responsibilities while keeping the remaining work visible, rather than describing the whole handover as complete.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. model mismatch | 2. replacement document | 3. follow-up owner | 4. update date | 5. callback | 6. open-item list | 7. Document receipt | 8. completion claim | 9. warranty record | 10. handover readback

Keep the call and visit separate

F Say it

Complete the closing exchange. Identify the model mismatch, named owner, call date, and unbooked return attendance.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Monday / booked / Leo / previous

08

Client: "The leaflet belongs to the ¹ _____ model."

Lead: "² _____ owns the replacement-leaflet follow-up."

Client: "The promised call is on ³ _____."

Lead: "The return visit is not yet ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. previous | 2. Leo | 3. Monday | 4. booked

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Identifying fixtures and service history

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. Which fixture does Mina mean?

A. The bathroom basin in Unit 3B

The brief identifies the bathroom basin, not the nearby utility sink.

2. What does 07:00 identify?

B. When Mina noticed water

The supplied time is an observation time, not a verified onset.

3. What is known about the source?

D. It has not been established

Water location alone does not identify its source in this report.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which question best clarifies the fixture?

D. Do you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink beside it?

The alternatives identify the fixture without assuming a failure or requesting work.

2. Which summary preserves the time accurately?

D. Water noticed on the cabinet base at 07:00

Noticed records the tenant's observation rather than onset or scheduling.

3. Which statement wrongly converts location into cause?

D. The water must be coming from the trap

The trap is not identified as the source by the supplied facts.

4. What should accompany the handoff?

B. Fixture, unit, observed surface, time, and unresolved source

These details preserve the usable report without adding unsupported history or conclusions.

01 Conversation answers

Identifying fixtures and service history

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. fixture.** Turn 2. Fixture names the particular appliance; the room contains two different sinks.
- 2. bathroom basin.** Turn 4. Bathroom basin resolves the two-fixture ambiguity using Mina's explicit clarification.
- 3. cabinet base.** Turn 6. Cabinet base identifies the observed surface without asserting where the water originated.
- 4. source.** Turn 8. Source concerns origin, which Mina's observation has not established.
- 5. observation time.** Turn 10. Observation time preserves when Mina noticed water without inventing the onset.
- 6. service history.** Turn 12. Service history concerns earlier work; none has been supplied, not proven absent.
- 7. faucet.** Turn 14. Faucet is the alternative name for the water-delivery fitting, not a diagnosis.
- 8. reported symptom.** Turn 16. Reported symptom distinguishes Mina's account from a confirmed component failure.
- 9. call summary.** Turn 18. Call summary gathers fixture, location, observation, and uncertainty for the next person.
- 10. attendance.** Turn 20. Attendance means the service visit being arranged, without promising a diagnosis or time.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. basin

Coordinator: "The tenant means the bathroom basin in Unit 3B."

Basin identifies the fixture Mina selected, not the adjacent utility sink.

2. base

Plumber: "Water was seen on the cabinet base."

Base names the observed surface without identifying the water source.

3. 07:00

Coordinator: "It was noticed at 07:00."

The time belongs to the observation, not a proven onset.

4. unestablished

Plumber: "The source remains unestablished."

The account supplies no assessment establishing which component caused the water.

02 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying pipe and component specifications

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What is Omar comparing?

B. A nominal designation and a measured outside diameter

The comparison uses a size designation and a physical measurement of a different kind.

2. What information is incomplete?

A. The delivery label

The order names a series, but the delivered item's label is incomplete.

3. What remains unverified?

D. Product identity and relevant compatibility

The supplied facts do not verify the delivered product or its compatibility.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which response best corrects the comparison?

B. Nominal size and outside diameter are different; we still need full item identification

The response corrects terminology while preserving the unresolved product check.

2. Which information should Leila request next?

C. Complete label details and product identification

Full identification is needed to reconcile the actual item with the order.

3. Which conclusion is unsupported?

D. The material and connection are compatible

Compatibility has not been verified by the available information.

4. What does a dimensional table need to match?

A. The relevant identified product and series

Dimensions must be read in the context of the actual identified product.

02 Conversation answers

Clarifying pipe and component specifications

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

- 1. nominal size.** Turn 2. Nominal size is the designation on the order, not necessarily the measured outside diameter.
- 2. outside diameter.** Turn 4. Outside diameter names the measured outer dimension Omar is comparing with a designation.
- 3. product identification.** Turn 6. Product identification remains incomplete because the delivery label does not fully identify the goods.
- 4. product series.** Turn 8. Product series provides the ordered family against which full delivery identification must be checked.
- 5. part number.** Turn 10. Part number identifies a particular manufacturer item more precisely than packaging appearance.
- 6. dimensional table.** Turn 12. Dimensional table defines measurements for the identified product rather than an unrelated pipe.
- 7. connection type.** Turn 14. Connection type concerns the joining interface and cannot be inferred from nominal size alone.
- 8. substitution.** Turn 16. Substitution means replacing a specified product; no such replacement is approved by this discussion.
- 9. acceptance status.** Turn 18. Acceptance status must remain unresolved while identification and compatibility checks are incomplete.
- 10. supply discrepancy.** Turn 20. Supply discrepancy identifies the unresolved delivery question without assuming either rejection or acceptance.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. nominal

Buyer: "The order gives a nominal size."

Nominal identifies a size designation rather than necessarily the measured diameter.

2. outside

Coordinator: "Your measurement is the outside diameter."

Outside names the physical dimension Omar compared with the designation.

3. label

Buyer: "The delivery label is incomplete."

The incomplete label prevents full identification of the supplied item.

4. unverified

Coordinator: "Compatibility remains unverified."

Neither material nor connection compatibility has been established by the facts.

03 Briefing and language checks

Reconciling fixture layouts and dimensions

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. What reference does the bathroom layout use?

B. The finished wall face

The layout explicitly measures from the finished wall face to the basin centerline.

2. Why do the two 450-millimeter dimensions conflict?

D. They start from different reference surfaces

Equal numbers do not produce equal positions when their reference surfaces differ.

3. What is not supplied?

D. A confirmed coordinated rough-in detail

The brief identifies basin B2 but leaves the coordinated rough-in detail unconfirmed.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which summary identifies the actual mismatch?

D. Both show 450 to the centerline, but one starts at the finished face and one at framing

The mismatch concerns the origin, not the number, units, or endpoint.

2. Which proposed action is unsupported?

D. Subtract an assumed finish thickness and release installation

No finish thickness or approved adjustment is supplied for such a conversion.

3. What does selecting B2 establish?

B. The chosen basin model, not a confirmed coordinated rough-in

The selected model does not resolve the differing references or missing detail.

4. Which question is most precise?

C. Which reference surface governs the coordinated centerline position?

Naming the reference surface targets the actual unresolved design issue.

03 Conversation answers

Reconciling fixture layouts and dimensions

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

- 1. framing face.** Turn 2. Framing face is the origin on the cabinet drawing, distinct from the finished wall surface.
- 2. dimension origin.** Turn 4. Dimension origin is the starting reference, which differs between these two dimensions.
- 3. finished wall face.** Turn 6. Finished wall face preserves the bathroom layout's stated origin rather than substituting framing.
- 4. finish thickness.** Turn 8. Finish thickness is missing, so an offset between framing and finished faces cannot be invented.
- 5. fixture schedule.** Turn 10. Fixture schedule identifies the selected basin; it does not settle the coordinated service positions.
- 6. coordinated detail.** Turn 12. Coordinated detail reconciles the plumbing and cabinet information rather than favoring an unverified drawing.
- 7. dimension readback.** Turn 14. Dimension readback repeats the number, origin, and endpoint so the actual ambiguity remains visible.
- 8. rough-in detail.** Turn 16. Rough-in detail remains unconfirmed despite the selected basin and matching numerical dimensions.
- 9. datum.** Turn 18. Datum names the governing reference that the designer needs to clarify.
- 10. design query.** Turn 20. Design query requests clarification without creating an installation instruction or approving an assumed offset.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. finished

Plumber: "The layout starts at the finished wall face."

Finished wall face is the origin explicitly stated on the bathroom layout.

2. framing

Coordinator: "The cabinet drawing starts at the framing face."

Framing face is the different origin used by the cabinet drawing.

3. centerline

Plumber: "Both dimensions end at the basin centerline."

Centerline is the shared endpoint, not the basin edge.

4. unconfirmed

Coordinator: "The coordinated rough-in detail remains unconfirmed."

Basin selection does not establish the missing coordinated rough-in detail.

04 Briefing and language checks

Describing moisture without diagnosing its source

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What was observed during the visit?

C. The visible ceiling patch was dry

Only the visible patch condition during the visit is established.

2. What is not visible?

B. The pipework

The brief explicitly states that no pipework is visible.

3. What remains unresolved?

D. The source of the staining

The visible surface condition does not establish the origin of the staining.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which statement is best supported?

D. The visible patch was dry during the visit; source unresolved

The supported wording preserves both the observation and the unresolved cause.

2. What is wrong with saying leak stopped?

A. It infers a change in a leak that has not been established

Dry surface condition does not establish an active leak's history or cessation.

3. Which phrase best communicates the inspection limit?

D. No pipework was visible from this position

The phrase states the actual visibility limit without inventing a broader examination.

4. What should the report avoid?

D. A repair or structural conclusion unsupported by the visit

Neither a completed repair nor structural assessment is supplied in the brief.

04 Conversation answers

Describing moisture without diagnosing its source

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. surface condition. Turn 2. Surface condition refers to the visible patch, not the state of concealed pipework.

2. visible patch. Turn 4. Visible patch limits the observation to the exposed stained area that Arun can see.

3. moisture source. Turn 6. Moisture source concerns origin, which the location below a washroom does not prove.

4. causal claim. Turn 8. Causal claim assigns the stain to the basin without evidence establishing that connection.

5. observation scope. Turn 10. Observation scope confines the statement to the visible surface during the visit.

6. inspection limitation. Turn 12. Inspection limitation identifies the concealed pipework that was not visible for assessment.

7. repair claim. Turn 14. Repair claim would assert completed corrective work, which this visit account does not establish.

8. qualified statement. Turn 16. Qualified statement provides explicit limits while still communicating a useful observation.

9. time qualifier. Turn 18. Time qualifier prevents a visit-specific observation from becoming a general assurance.

10. finding summary. Turn 20. Finding summary reports established observations and limits without claiming a diagnosis or resolution.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. dry

Owner: "The visible patch was dry during the visit."

Dry is the observed surface condition during the stated attendance.

2. pipework

Plumber: "No pipework was visible."

The concealed pipework limits what this observation can establish.

3. established

Owner: "The source is not established."

The stain location and dry patch do not identify the source.

4. assessment

Plumber: "The source still needs assessment."

Further assessment is needed, without a promised diagnosis or outcome.

04

05 Briefing and language checks

Explaining drainage and access terminology

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What does the removable panel provide?

A. Access to the recorded cleanout

The panel is an access feature, not an additional drainage fixture.

2. What has Hana requested?

C. Permanent covering of the panel area

The client requests permanent covering, but no approval is established.

3. Who needs to coordinate the detail?

D. The designer with the plumbing team

The supplied next step is design coordination with the plumbing team.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which explanation is clearest?

B. The panel lets the relevant team reach the cleanout; it is not another drain

The explanation separates the access cover from the drainage-maintenance feature.

2. What should Dev do with Hana's preference?

A. Record it for design coordination without approving concealment

Recording a preference does not establish an acceptable access arrangement.

3. Which claim is unsupported?

B. The drawn panel dimensions are approved and sufficient

No approved dimensions or verified access arrangement are supplied.

4. What is the appropriate next step?

B. Coordinate the access detail with the designer and plumbing team

The case calls for design coordination, not client intervention or assumed equivalence.

05 Conversation answers

Explaining drainage and access terminology

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. access panel.** Turn 2. Access panel is the cover shown in the cabinet drawing, not another drain.
- 2. cleanout.** Turn 4. Cleanout identifies drainage-maintenance access, distinct from the basin's waste outlet.
- 3. appearance request.** Turn 6. Appearance request preserves Hana's preference without turning it into an approved enclosure change.
- 4. access detail.** Turn 8. Access detail determines how required access is provided within the proposed cabinet arrangement.
- 5. clear opening.** Turn 10. Clear opening is the usable access space, whose approved dimensions are not supplied here.
- 6. fixed panel.** Turn 12. Fixed panel does not automatically perform the access function of the removable panel it would replace.
- 7. access requirement.** Turn 14. Access requirement concerns the conditions the final arrangement must satisfy, independent of appearance preference.
- 8. design intent.** Turn 16. Design intent explains the access function that must not be lost through the client's earlier terminology.
- 9. coordination response.** Turn 18. Coordination response is the relevant combined review needed before the access arrangement can be confirmed.
- 10. review status.** Turn 20. Review status preserves the distinction between a client request and an accepted design change.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. drain

Client: "The panel is not an extra drain."

The feature provides access rather than acting as an additional drain.

2. cleanout

Coordinator: "It provides access to a cleanout."

Cleanout is the recorded drainage-maintenance access feature behind the panel.

3. detail

Client: "The designer will coordinate the access detail."

The access detail must reconcile the cabinet arrangement with plumbing requirements.

4. approved

Coordinator: "Permanent covering is not yet approved."

The plumber has not reviewed the proposed enclosure change for acceptance.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Coordinating interruptions and room access

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. What is booked for 09:00?

B. The plumbing visit

The booked time belongs to attendance, not to the proposed interruption.

2. What is the proposed interruption window?

B. 10:00-11:00

The proposal is specifically 10:00-11:00 and remains pending approval.

3. What is the stated affected area?

D. The east washroom only

The supplied scope is limited to the east washroom.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which notice wording preserves all supplied facts?

B. Visit 09:00; east-washroom interruption proposed 10:00-11:00, pending approval

The first wording separates the booked visit from the limited, unapproved interruption.

2. What is wrong with only changing whole building to east washroom?

D. Timing and approval status may still be wrong

Correcting the area alone does not correct the arrival-time confusion or pending approval.

3. Which item is already confirmed?

D. The 09:00 visit booking

The case confirms attendance only, not the proposed service interruption.

4. What should Joel avoid treating the message as?

A. Permission to operate valves or start an interruption

Scheduling language does not provide an operational instruction or authorization.

06 Conversation answers

Coordinating interruptions and room access

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

- 1. attendance time.** Turn 2. Attendance time belongs to the booked visit and does not establish the start of an interruption.
- 2. interruption window.** Turn 4. Interruption window identifies the separate proposed service pause from 10:00 to 11:00.
- 3. affected area.** Turn 6. Affected area is limited to the east washroom, not the entire building.
- 4. status qualifier.** Turn 8. Status qualifier retains proposed status and prevents the revised notice from implying approval.
- 5. building manager.** Turn 10. Building manager is the named approval role whose decision remains pending in the case.
- 6. notice wording.** Turn 12. Notice wording should distinguish the booked visit from the proposed, limited interruption.
- 7. access arrangement.** Turn 14. Access arrangement must come from actual coordination rather than being inferred from the visit booking.
- 8. schedule readback.** Turn 16. Schedule readback preserves both times, the limited area, and the unresolved approval in one accurate summary.
- 9. operating instruction.** Turn 18. Operating instruction would direct equipment action, which this scheduling conversation does not authorize.
- 10. coordination update.** Turn 20. Coordination update communicates the corrected arrangements while keeping the outstanding decision explicit.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. 09:00

Coordinator: "The visit is booked for 09:00."

The confirmed booking concerns attendance at nine, not the service interruption.

2. 10:00-11:00

Representative: "The interruption is proposed for 10:00-11:00."

The proposed window starts at ten and ends at eleven.

3. east

Coordinator: "It concerns the east washroom only."

East washroom is the stated limited area in the proposal.

4. pending

Representative: "Building-manager approval remains pending."

Pending preserves the fact that the proposed interruption is not yet approved.

07 Briefing and language checks

Pricing changes and restoration boundaries

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What does the current estimate cover?

B. Replacing B1 with the specified basin model

The stated estimate concerns replacement of B1 with the specified model.

2. What is Ava assuming?

B. The fixture allowance includes cabinet changes and redecoration

The brief names these related works as Ava's assumption, not quoted inclusions.

3. What remains unassessed?

D. Access requirements and revised plumbing scope

The changed arrangement still needs assessment before its scope or terms can be confirmed.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which response best addresses Ava's assumption?

C. The estimate covers B1 replacement; cabinet changes and redecoration are not listed

The response states the estimate's actual coverage and identifies the unlisted related work.

2. What must happen before revised terms can be confirmed?

B. Assess access requirements and define the revised scope

The changed arrangement requires assessment before price and timing can be established.

3. Which phrase overpromises?

B. The wall-hung vanity will cost exactly the same and finish on the original date

Neither unchanged cost nor unchanged timing is supported for the unassessed change.

4. What does making good need in an agreement?

D. A defined extent of restoration

Restoration boundaries must be stated rather than inferred from a broad phrase.

07 Conversation answers

Pricing changes and restoration boundaries

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

- 1. estimate.** Turn 2. Estimate refers to the existing cost document for the specified B1 replacement.
- 2. fixture allowance.** Turn 4. Fixture allowance has the scope stated in the estimate and does not establish all related work as included.
- 3. change request.** Turn 6. Change request records the new arrangement without treating it as agreed scope or accepted price.
- 4. access requirements.** Turn 8. Access requirements concern reaching the changed work and remain unassessed in the case.
- 5. cabinet alteration.** Turn 10. Cabinet alteration is related work not listed in the original estimate, not a predetermined technical requirement.
- 6. making good.** Turn 12. Making good means agreed restoration and needs a defined extent rather than an unlimited assumption.
- 7. additional cost.** Turn 14. Additional cost cannot be fixed reliably while the changed work and access remain unassessed.
- 8. completion date.** Turn 16. Completion date for the changed work is not established by the original estimate.
- 9. revised quotation.** Turn 18. Revised quotation sets out a price proposal for a defined changed scope rather than merely restating the product allowance.
- 10. approval to proceed.** Turn 20. Approval to proceed with extra work has not been given by this assessment request.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. B1

Estimator: "The estimate covers replacement of B1 with the specified model."

B1 identifies the fixture in the original stated estimate.

2. redecoration

Client: "Cabinet changes and redecoration are not listed."

Redecoration is one of the related works not listed in the estimate.

3. assessment

Estimator: "The revised scope still needs assessment."

The access requirements and changed plumbing scope have not yet been assessed.

4. confirmed

Client: "Price and timing are not yet confirmed for the change."

Revised terms cannot be treated as agreed while the changed scope remains unassessed.

08 Briefing and language checks

Handing over plumbing records and follow-up

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What is wrong with the care leaflet?

C. It belongs to the previous model

The supplied leaflet does not match the current model in the handover pack.

2. What does Leo promise for Monday?

C. A call about follow-up

Monday is the promised communication date, not a booked site visit.

3. What remains unscheduled?

B. The return visit for cosmetic-trim review

The cosmetic-trim review needs a return visit, but no date is booked.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover summary is accurate?

A. Pack received; wrong-model leaflet pending replacement; Leo calls Monday; trim visit unbooked

The summary preserves receipt, document correction, ownership, callback, and unbooked visit.

2. What would turn the callback into an unsupported promise?

B. Telling Maya the team will attend on Monday

The promise concerns a call; no return appointment has been booked.

3. Which action best handles the leaflet mismatch?

D. Obtain the document for the current model

The correct model-specific document is needed rather than an assumed equivalent.

4. What is not changed by this conversation?

D. The actual warranty terms

A follow-up conversation does not itself revise the applicable warranty terms.

08 Conversation answers

Handing over plumbing records and follow-up

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. model mismatch.** Turn 2. Model mismatch identifies the leaflet's previous-model reference rather than denying receipt of the pack.
- 2. replacement document.** Turn 4. Replacement document is the correct model-specific leaflet needed to resolve the mismatch.
- 3. follow-up owner.** Turn 6. Follow-up owner names Leo as the person responsible for progressing the leaflet correction.
- 4. update date.** Turn 8. Update date is the promised communication date, not an appointment for the separate trim review.
- 5. callback.** Turn 10. Callback means the promised phone communication and does not establish site attendance.
- 6. open-item list.** Turn 12. Open-item list should retain the document correction and visit arrangement as distinct unfinished matters.
- 7. Document receipt.** Turn 14. Document receipt acknowledges delivery without verifying the accuracy or suitability of each enclosed record.
- 8. completion claim.** Turn 16. Completion claim would wrongly describe the trim as corrected when only a future review is required.
- 9. warranty record.** Turn 18. Warranty record retains its actual terms; the callback and open items do not automatically revise them.
- 10. handover readback.** Turn 20. Handover readback preserves received records, open corrections, ownership, and the distinction between call and visit.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. previous

Client: "The leaflet belongs to the previous model."

Previous identifies why the supplied leaflet does not match the current product.

2. Leo

Lead: "Leo owns the replacement-leaflet follow-up."

Leo explicitly accepts responsibility for obtaining the correct care leaflet.

3. Monday

Client: "The promised call is on Monday."

Monday is the communication commitment rather than the return-visit date.

4. booked

Lead: "The return visit is not yet booked."

The cosmetic-trim review requires attendance, but no appointment date is confirmed.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Identifying fixtures and service history

Offer two concrete choices: Do you mean the bathroom basin or the utility sink?

Locate the observation: Where had you already noticed the water?

Keep the report attributed: The tenant reports water beneath the bathroom basin.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Clarifying pipe and component specifications

Acknowledge the concern: I understand why those two numbers look inconsistent.

Retain the measurement: We should keep your measurement in the record.

Avoid premature rejection: The numerical difference alone does not prove the delivery is wrong.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Reconciling fixture layouts and dimensions

State the layout reference: The layout measures from the finished wall face.

Preserve the number: Both drawings state 450 millimeters.

Ask the design question: Which datum should the coordinated detail use?

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Describing moisture without diagnosing its source

Acknowledge the concern: I understand why you want to know whether it has stopped.

Identify the limitation: No pipework is visible from this position.

Keep uncertainty specific: We cannot infer that a leak has stopped from this surface alone.

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Explaining drainage and access terminology

Clarify the label: That symbol identifies an access panel, not an extra drain.

Acknowledge the appearance concern: I understand that you want a continuous cabinet finish.

Keep function distinct: Hiding a component and preserving access are different questions.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Coordinating interruptions and room access

Separate the appointment: The visit is booked for 09:00.

Name the approval: Building-manager approval is still pending.

Avoid overstating certainty: We cannot describe that window as confirmed yet.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Pricing changes and restoration boundaries

State the original coverage: The estimate covers replacement of B1 with the specified model.

Name the unlisted work: Cabinet changes and redecoration are not listed here.

Keep the plumbing scope open: The revised plumbing scope also needs assessment.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Handing over plumbing records and follow-up

Acknowledge receipt: You have received the handover pack for B1.

Avoid applying the wrong guidance: I cannot treat that leaflet as confirmed guidance for this model.

Separate the visit: The cosmetic-trim review needs a return visit.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

acceptance status preserve acceptance status	15
access arrangement coordinate the access arrangement	51
access detail coordinate the access detail	41
access panel retain an access panel	41
access requirement establish the access requirement	42
access requirements assess access requirements	59
active leak establish an active leak	32
adapter identify the adapter	15
additional cost assess additional cost	60
affected area identify the affected area	50
alignment coordinate fixture alignment	24
appearance request record the appearance request	42
approval to proceed obtain approval to proceed	60
approved interruption distinguish an approved interruption	50
assessment arrange an assessment	33
assumed conversion avoid an assumed conversion	24
attendance arrange attendance	6
attendance time confirm the attendance time	50
attribution preserve attribution	33
basin centerline locate the basin centerline	23
basin replacement define the basin replacement	59
bathroom basin specify the bathroom basin	5
booking confirmation read the booking confirmation	50
building manager seek building-manager approval	50

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

cabinet alteration	price cabinet alterations	59
cabinet base	report water on the cabinet base	5
cabinet drawing	compare the cabinet drawing	23
cabinet elevation	read the cabinet elevation	41
call summary	read back the call summary	6
callback	commit to a callback	69
care guidance	use model-specific care guidance	68
care leaflet	obtain the correct care leaflet	68
causal claim	avoid an unsupported causal claim	33
ceiling stain	record the ceiling stain	32
change request	record a change request	60
cleanout	identify the recorded cleanout	41
clear opening	verify the clear opening	41
clearance	verify the relevant clearance	24
client concern	acknowledge the client concern	33
client selection	record the client selection	60
closeout	manage closeout	69
commercial terms	confirm commercial terms	60
compatibility	verify compatibility	15
completion claim	verify a completion claim	69
completion date	confirm the completion date	60
concealed pipework	distinguish concealed pipework	32
concealment	review proposed concealment	42
confirmed appointment	distinguish the confirmed appointment	51

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

connection type identify the connection type	14
coordinated detail issue a coordinated detail	24
coordination response await the coordination response	42
coordination update provide a coordination update	51
cosmetic trim review the cosmetic trim	68
coupling specify the coupling	15
current model identify the current model	68
datum identify the datum	23
delivery label check the delivery label	14
design intent clarify the design intent	42
design query raise a design query	24
diagnosis distinguish observation from diagnosis	33
dimension endpoint identify the dimension endpoint	23
dimension origin confirm the dimension origin	23
dimension readback give a dimension readback	24
dimensional table consult the dimensional table	15
document correction track the document correction	68
document receipt confirm document receipt	68
drain distinguish the drain	41
drainage line locate the drainage line	41
drawing reference cite the drawing reference	24
dry at the visit state dry at the visit	32
east washroom specify the east washroom	50
elbow identify the elbow	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

enclosure change	review the enclosure change	42
end time	state the end time	51
estimate	review the estimate	59
evidence	distinguish evidence from assumption	33
faucet	name the faucet	6
finding summary	give a finding summary	33
finish panel	coordinate the finish panel	42
finish thickness	confirm the finish thickness	24
finished wall face	measure from the finished wall face	23
fitting	identify the fitting	15
fixed panel	distinguish a fixed panel	42
fixture	identify the fixture	5
fixture allowance	clarify the fixture allowance	59
fixture location	state the fixture location	5
fixture schedule	consult the fixture schedule	23
follow-up owner	name the follow-up owner	69
framing face	reference the framing face	23
handover pack	receive the handover pack	68
handover readback	give a handover readback	69
hinged panel	identify a hinged panel	42
historical staining	distinguish historical staining	32
impact scope	define the impact scope	50
inside diameter	distinguish inside diameter	14
inspection limitation	explain the inspection limitation	33

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

installation position confirm the installation position	24
interface resolve the cabinet interface	24
intermittent condition describe an intermittent condition	32
interruption window state the interruption window	50
layout drawing review the layout drawing	23
maintenance allow for maintenance	41
making good define making good	59
material specification confirm the material specification	14
measured dimension record the measured dimension	14
model mismatch record the model mismatch	68
moisture source investigate the moisture source	32
nominal size confirm the nominal size	14
notice release confirm notice release	51
notice wording correct the notice wording	50
observation scope define the observation scope	32
observation time record the observation time	5
obstruction identify an obstruction	42
occupant communication prepare occupant communication	51
offset calculate a verified offset	24
onset distinguish onset from observation	5
open-item list maintain the open-item list	69
operating instruction distinguish an operating instruction	51
order line reconcile the order line	14
outside diameter compare the outside diameter	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

outstanding item retain an outstanding item	69
part number verify the part number	14
pending approval retain pending-approval status	50
permanent enclosure review a permanent enclosure	41
previous model distinguish the previous model	68
previous repair confirm a previous repair	6
price assumption correct a price assumption	60
product identification complete product identification	15
product record reconcile the product record	68
product series identify the product series	14
proposed interruption describe the proposed interruption	50
qualified statement make a qualified statement	33
recurrence record a recurrence	32
redcoration distinguish redecoration	59
reducer identify the reducer	15
removable cover specify a removable cover	41
repair claim verify a repair claim	33
replacement document request the replacement document	68
reported symptom retain the reported symptom	6
resolution avoid premature resolution	33
restoration boundary clarify the restoration boundary	60
return visit arrange the return visit	68
review status confirm the review status	42
revised quotation prepare a revised quotation	60

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

revised scope agree the revised scope	59
room availability clarify room availability	51
rough-in coordinate the rough-in	23
rough-in detail confirm the rough-in detail	23
schedule readback give a schedule readback	51
scope boundary explain the scope boundary	60
scope exclusion check scope exclusions	59
scope inclusion identify scope inclusions	59
selected model verify the selected model	23
service access preserve service access	41
service call log a service call	5
service history check the service history	6
service record update the service record	69
serviceable verify a serviceable arrangement	42
size designation read the size designation	14
source establish the source	5
specified model retain the specified model	59
start time preserve the start time	51
status qualifier preserve the status qualifier	51
status update provide a status update	69
substitution review a substitution	15
supply connection identify a supply connection	6
supply discrepancy investigate a supply discrepancy	15
surface condition report the surface condition	32

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

tap clarify the tap description	6
tee specify the tee	15
tenant report record the tenant report	5
tenant representative brief the tenant representative	50
time qualifier retain the time qualifier	33
trade coordination arrange trade coordination	60
trap identify the basin trap	6
unit number confirm the unit number	5
unknown cause record an unknown cause	6
unlisted work identify unlisted work	60
update date confirm the update date	69
utility sink distinguish the utility sink	5
vanity unit describe the vanity unit	5
visible moisture describe visible moisture	6
visible patch describe the visible patch	32
visit booking distinguish a visit booking	69
wall build-up establish the wall build-up	24
wall thickness specify the wall thickness	14
wall-hung vanity assess the wall-hung vanity request	59
warranty record retain the warranty record	69
washroom locate the upstairs washroom	32
waste connection describe the waste connection	6
waste outlet identify the waste outlet	41
whole-building claim correct a whole-building claim	51

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Bureau of Labor Statistics. Plumbers, Pipefitters, and Steamfitters.

[Open the original source](#)

Occupational context for fixtures, project drawings, estimates, and coordination. No installation or repair procedures are reproduced. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Charlotte Pipe. ChemDrain Technical and Installation Manual.

[Open the original source](#)

Terminology reference distinguishing nominal size and outside diameter. The book gives no product sizing, compatibility, or installation decisions. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] Oatey. Access Panels.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for describing access to concealed services. Examples do not specify compliant panel dimensions or approve enclosure changes. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Kohler. Product Support.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for model identification, technical documents, care information, and warranty records. Fictional cases do not reproduce product instructions. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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